The New Evangelicalism the present peril

By C. R. STAM

THE PRESENT PERIL

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By

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CONTENTS

Preface 6

CHAPTER I

The New Evangelicalism 8
What is the New Evangelicalism? 8
Neo-evangelical Claims 8

CHAPTER II

A Basic Disagreement 10
The New Evangelicalism and Dispensationalism 10
Throwing Away the Key 14

CHAPTER III

The New Evangelicalism and Intellectualism 17
The Lack of Fundamentalist Scholarship 17
What saith the Scripture? 17
Downgrading Fundamentalist Scholarship 19
The Relative Value of Higher Education 20
Intellectualism Not the Answer 20
The Passion for Intellectualism a Grave Danger 22
Intellectual Pride 24
The Value of True Wisdom 26
An Earnest Prayer 29

CHAPTER IV

The New Evangelicalism and the Fundamentals of the Faith 31
Neo-Evangelical Claims 31
Neo-Evangelical Claims Questioned 32
Faith and Love 35

CHAPTER V

The New Evangelicalism and Science 38
An Amazing Book 38
The Bible Brought Into Question 39
Neo-evangelicalism Bowing Low Before Science 41
Failure and Success 43
The Church and Lost Souls 44
Why Is Science Antagonistic? 44
The Great Need Today 46

CHAPTER VI

The New Evangelicalism and Social Responsibility 50
Modernism, Fundamentalism and the Social Gospel 50
A Fundamentalist Setback 51
A Neo-evangelical Complaint 52
What the Bible Says About “Society” 55

Confused Intellectuals 58

CHAPTER VII

The New Evangelicalism and the Separated Life 61
True Sanctification 61
Neo-evangelicalism and the World 62
Separation – A Stand 67
Be Ye Separate 69

CHAPTER VIII

The New Evangelicalism and Apostate Religion 71
The Bible and Apostate Religion 71
Neo-evangelical Laxity in This Area 71
The Doctrine of the One Body 72
The Doctrine of Infiltration 73
The Results of Compromise 74

CHAPTER IX

The New Evangelicalism and Evangelism 78
Evangelistic Challenge 78
Doctrinal Weakness 79
Theological Laxity 79
Arminianism 81
Dispensational Weakness 82
Spiritual Weakness 87
Doing Things Big 89

CHAPTER X

A Resolution 92
A Resolution Regarding the New Evangelicalism 92

Preface

What title shall we give to this book on the new evangelicalism? *The Devil in Disguise?* No, that wouldn't do, for some might gather from such a title that we consider sincere Christians who have fallen for neo-evangelicalism the conscious agents of Satan. This, of course, we do *not* believe. Rather we believe that most, if not all, neo-evangelicals are sincere, both in their faith in Christ and in their desire to win others to Him.

But the new evangelicalism *as such* is a subtle attack of Satan upon the true Church; an effort to neutralize the faith of Bible-believing Christians and to rob them of the power of the Spirit in their lives.

Paul knew what he was talking about when he used the phrase: "lest Satan should get an advantage of us" (II Cor. 2:11), for this is exactly what our spiritual adversary is forever trying to do.

In this case he has taken advantage of a very commendable desire on the part of sincere believers: the desire for Christian unity. While this writer is a fundamentalist and wishes so to be known, he must confess that the fundamentalists have not been united (except *in Christ)* and that their disunity has done the cause of Christ much harm. This is what gave rise to the new evangelicalism.

Rather than acknowledging the seventold "unity of the Spirit" (Eph. 4:8-6), upon which alone true Christian unity must be based, the neo-evangelicals have sought union by compromise. "Let's get together on those things wherein we *do* agree," they say to a divided Church, continuing all the while to close their eyes and their hearts to the revealed plan of God for the present dispensation, and promoting instead the always-futile effort to fulfil a program they were never commissioned to carry out (See Matt. 28:19-21; Mark 16:15-18; and cf. Gal. 2:2,7,9).

But as we view their efforts we must ask three questions:

1. "How can two walk together except they be agreed?"

2. How can we be intelligent as co-workers with God if we do not clearly understand His purpose, His plan, for the dispensation in which we live?

3. If saved Presbyterians, Baptists, Methodists, Episcopalians, Lutherans, etc., "get together" only on those things wherein they all agree, will not their common beliefs be reduced to a bare minimum?

And this is exactly what the new evangelicalism has done. The neo-evangelicals are no less confused or diversified in their beliefs than are the fundamentalists. They only stand for less, thus failing to give due importance to the Word of God and "the obedience of faith."

But "the father of lies" is taking advantage of another commendable desire in sincere believers: the desire to see souls brought to a saving knowledge of Christ. Appearing in his present-day disguise, as "an angel of light," he argues: "Why be so rigid in your stand? The world is not all that bad! The religious apostasy is not that frightening! Rather than remaining aloof, become involved with the world--*to win souls to Christ.* Join hands with religious liberals in united efforts *to win greater numbers to Him."* And so, appealing to a praiseworthy desire to see precious souls come to know Christ, the adversary has induced many a sincere believer to let down his guard. And it is when the believer lets down his guard, when he fails to *"stand against the wiles of the devil,"* that he invites spiritual disaster. Many such have been, first captivated, then captured by the world, while others have "made shipwreck of the faith."

This is the twofold peril of the new evangelicalism. It actually teaches the believer to let down his guard and encourages him to compromise, not only with other believers, but even with the world and with apostate religion--and all this is sternly condemned by the Word of God.

Still, let's not title this volume, *The Devil in Disguise;* let's rather call it *The Present Peril,* and pray that God in His grace will use it to awaken many a believer at a time when most are falling asleep, and so to rescue them from the spiritual disaster that inevitably overtakes sleeping Christians.

Cornelius R. Stam

CHICAGO, ILLINOIS
March 15, 1968

Chapter I

THE NEW EVANGELICALISM

WHAT IS THE NEW EVANGELICALISM?

“Watch ye, stand fast in the faith." -- I Cor. 16:13.

We have before us a volume titled *The New Evangelicalism,* by Ronald H. Nash. Nash's book is an accepted defense of neo-evangelicalism. Indeed, Harold John Ockeriga, an outstanding neo-evangelical and the one who is said to have coined the term[1], has written: "One would be hard put to find a book with which he agreed more thoroughly.”[2]

Nash points out in his book that as fundamentalism was a reaction to the errors of modernism at the turn of the century, so neo-evangelicalism is a reaction to the failures of fundamentalism.

Neo-evangelicalism opposes fundamentalism, not in its stand for the essentials of the Christian faith, but in what is felt to be fundamentalism's want of intellectual scholarship, its extreme separatism, its lack of a sense of social responsibility and especially its dispensationalism.

Since neo-evangelicals feel themselves to be in agreement with the fundamentalists on the essentials of the faith, Nash prefers to call this school of thought *evangelicalism* rather than *neo-evangelicalism*. "Furthermore," says Nash regarding the latter term, "the name is misleading because many of the positions held by evangelicals are not new at all. Often they are simply a return to positions held previously by much of orthodox scholarship ....”[3]

This latter may be true, but note his words "many," "often" and "much," for it is also true that "many" of the positions held by the neo-evangelicals *are* new and do *not* constitute "a return to positions held previously by much of orthodox scholarship."

We hold that this sets it apart as a new kind of evangelicalism and that to call it simply evangelicalism is not only misleading but takes unfair advantage in a controversy, since Protestant fundamentalists were called evangelicals long before this new school of thought came into existence.

NEO-EVANGELICAL CLAIMS

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[1] Nash, *op. cit.,* P. 13.
[2] Testimony on the Jacket of *The New Evangelicalism.*
[3] *Ibid.,* P. 175.

From what we have said above it follows that neo-evangelicalism is not to be confused with what is known as *neo-orthodoxy,* much less with modernism. In his book Nash makes the following claims for neo-evangelicalism:

"It's still as concerned over preserving the Christian essentials as were the early fundamentalists. [4]

"... the evangelical is as anxious to defend the great verities of the Christian faith as any fundamentalist .... "[5]

"The evangelical is as against liberalism in its many form as ever."[6]

"Thus the real reason behind this restudy of inspiration is a desire to restate the conservative position so as to *contrast* it with the neo-orthodox approach."[7]

Whether or not these claim are completely valid will be discussed later on, but suffice it to say here that Nash *also* claims that "Evangelicals are more conscious than fundamentalists of the need to carry on an exchange of ideas with liberal and neo-orthodox theologians,"[8] and referring to "conservative dissatisfaction with the evangelical position," he quotes Carl Henry to point out that neo-evangelicalism is "a mediating view, or perhaps better described as a perspective above the extremes."[9]

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[4] *Ibid.,* P. 32.
[5] *Ibid.,* P. 92.
[6] *Ibid.,* P. 96.
[7] *Ibid.,* P. 35.
[8] *Ibid.,* P. 102.
[9] *Ibid.,* P., 103.

Chapter II

A BASIC DISAGREEMENT

THE NEW EVANGELICALISM AND DISPENSATIONALISM

As a class the neo-evangelicals oppose dispensationalism. In his preface to *The New Evangelicalism,* Nash states that "one of the basic disagreements between evangelicalism and fundamentalism is over the matter of dispensationalism." He recognizes that there are some among the fundamentalists who oppose dispensationalism, but declares that "whenever and to whatever extent that fundamentalism is characterized by dispensationalism, then it and evangelicalism *do* differ doctrinally."[10]

Nash refers to "the dismal morass of dispensationalism,"[11] and is "convinced that there is a thorough-going refutation of dispensationalism," though "he is not naive enough to suppose that he could present it in one chapter."[12] As far as we know he has not even presented his refutation in one *book.* We feel he should do this since he has stated that "one of the *basic* disagreements between evangelicalism and fundamentalism is over the matter of dispensationalism,"[13] and has also applauded neo-evangelicalism as follows: "Time and again we have noticed how the evangelical does not shirk his responsibility to square his faith with the facts."[14]

FUNDAMENTALISM AND DISPENSATIONALISM

As Paul declared before Israel's sanhedrin: *"Men and brethren, I am a Pharisee," so* this writer declares: *"I am a fundamentalist."*

There was much that was wrong with the Pharisees of Paul's day, yet doctrinally he stood with them against the liberal teachings of the Sadducees. Likewise much is wrong with the fundamentalists of our day, but doctrinally we stand with them against the liberal teachings of modernism.

Like the neo-evangelicals, we deplore the decline of fundamentalism; its smug complacency, its multiplied divisions, its lack of concern for the multitudes about them who have not been *confronted* with the gospel, the waning of its passion to simply know God's truth and make it known, its growing failure to *teach the Bible,* its steady loss of the power of the Spirit.

However, whereas some neo-evangelicals hold that this decline among fundamentalists is due largely to their having embraced dispensationalism, we hold

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[10] *Ibid.*
[11] *Op. cit*., P. 176.
[12] *Ibid*., Preface.
[13] *Ibid*., Preface (our emphasis).
[14] *Ibid.,* P. 166.

that their decline is the direct result of *their failure to go on* in dispensational truth as God has given them light.

In 1909 Dr. C. I. Scofield wrote the following passage in the Introduction to the *Scofield Reference Bible:*

"The last fifty years have witnessed an intensity and breadth of interest in Bible study unprecedented in the history of the Christian Church. Never before have so many reverent, learned and spiritual men brought to the study of the Scriptures minds so free from merely controversial motive. A new and vast exegetical and expository literature has been created .... "

A glance over the books in our own modest library bears out the truth of Dr. Scofield's statement, for many of our very richest Bible commentaries and expositions come from the era to which he referred.

Taking advantage of this opportunity, Dr. Scofield, along with a group of consulting editors, compiled the *Scofield Reference Bible* in the face of many difficulties and much Satanic opposition.

The *Scofield Reference Bible* contained many helpful features, including its subject headings and helps at hard places where they occur, but the underlying reason for its tremendous influence through the years has been the fact that it was built upon the dispensational principle of interpretation, which Darby, Scofield and others had been emphasizing.

To thousands who studied the *Scofield Reference Bible,* seeming discrepancies in Scripture disappeared as they saw how God's dealings with men have been *progressive,* unfolding step by step with the advance of the ages. Passages which had meant little or nothing to them now sprang to life and became vital and meaningful. The Bible became an open Book to them. They now *enjoyed* Bible study. As a result the spiritual experience of thousands was enriched, multitudes were added to the Church in the right way, by faith in God's Word intelligently understood, the Bible Conference and Bible school movement flourished and missionaries, in unprecedented numbers, were sent to carry the gospel to foreign lands.

Not that the *Scofield Reference Bible* was the ultimate in dispensational truth. By no means. But it was an excellent start and demonstrated how God blesses the Church when she goes forward in the study of His Word.

Of course there were some truly born again believers, especially in the Reformed and Presbyterian denominations, who never accepted the dispensational principle of interpreting the Bible, and strangely they were the very ones who should have been the first to recognize its validity. But the really *live* segment among fundamentalist believers was the dispensational segment. It was among the dispensationalists that pastors *taught* the Scriptures from the pulpit. It was among the dispensationalists that people carried their Bibles to church and

followed the preacher as he expounded the Word. It was the dispensationalists who were using their Bibles to win others to Christ. There was no doubt about it; God had used the *Scofield Reference Bible* and those who stood for dispensational truth to bring about a spiritual revival in the Church, the results of which are still felt among us.

The years that followed the publication of the *Scofield Reference Bible* produced many great Bible expositors, but their number has since dwindled fast, until today evangelistic-revival campaigns which are generally shallow to say the least, have all but replaced the great, thrilling Bible conferences of a few decades ago.

The dispensational truth of the distinctive character of Paul's message, with its "one body" and "one baptism," has stopped many Bible teachers short and hindered them from bringing to the Scriptures "minds free from merely controversial motive," largely because the price of accepting and teaching this precious truth has seemed too great, but *until it is the sole passion of men of God to know THE TRUTH and make it known, revival will not come,* for the Church has never made one step of progress apart from *progress in the study of the Word.*

We well recall the case of a gifted young pastor who accepted a call to an independent fundamentalist church in New Jersey. Doctrinally he was a Presbyterian and, in his words, "proud of it." What he did not yet realize was that most of the leaders in his congregation were immersionists. Naturally they began asking him questions about his views and pressing him for answers.

Finally he agreed that he would restudy the whole subject of baptism and give them a comprehensive answer in due time.

It was at this time that someone gave this brother some literature by Pastor J. C. O'Hair and this writer. After some weeks of comparing our Scriptural position with those of denominational writers he was convinced. One day he came to this writer and said: "Neill, this is revolutionary, but it is incontrovertible," and he went on for some time explaining how a recognition of Paul's distinctive apostleship was *the answer to* his problem. We were gratified to hear this but realized that he did not yet *understand* the cost involved in *standing* for the truths he had come to rejoice in.

Some weeks later we met him again. This time he asked: "Neill, are you aware of the fact that these teachings have made you rather unpopular in some circles?" Earnestly we replied: "If you are even thinking of popularity, by all means do not study this subject further, for God will surely hold you responsible for the light He gives you."

This man, now a neo-evangelical, has become an opponent of dispensationalism but, like Nash, he has yet to produce "a 'thorough-going refutation" of it.

Nash refers[15] to an article published in *Christian Life* magazine in March, 1956, under the title *"Is Evangelical Theology Changing?"* and notes its report on an alleged "shift away from so-called dispensationalism." But there is more to this story.

In the *Christian Life* article Warren Young and Wilbur Smith were quoted as making the following statements respectively:

"The trend today is away from dispensationalism--away from the Scofield notes.... "

"I am sure that there is a growing repudiation of extreme dispensational views. In fact many who are absolutely conservative in their eschatological beliefs rarely use the word dispensational now."

But *Christian Life* had labeled the Scofield notes: as "extreme dispensationalism" in its sub-heading, and certainly Dr. Smith appeared to place as a favorable alternative to this "extreme" dispensationalism the omission of *any* mention of dispensationalism.[16]

As to the "trend sway from dispensationalism--away from the Scofield notes," we wrote the Editor of *Christian Life,* requesting him, in the interest of publishing *all* the facts, to inform his readers that concurrent with the shift sway from dispensational teaching among some leaders, there has been a growing emphasis upon dispensationalism and an increasingly widespread interest in it among others, as is evidenced by the rise and growth, in recent years, of half a dozen organizations emphasizing this method of Bible study. Among these is the *Berean Bible Society.*

The response from *Christian Life?* The same old thing. The Editorial Director replied that after we had published this information in the *Berean Searchlight* he would "consider" part of it, "although I cannot guarantee publication." To date *Christian Life* has carried not one word of this, though the September issue of that year did contain a sizeable report of an interview with Dr. English about dispensationalism and the *Scofield Reference Bible* revision. Thus we must ask: Do they *wish* their readers to know all the facts?

Is it not passing strange that the further development of dispensational truth since the Scofield era has been opposed, misrepresented and ridiculed; that its enemies have warned the Christian public of its growing influence, yet withal not even a 100-page book has been published to *answer* it Scripturally. Seeing that, in the words of Nash, "the evangelical does not shirk his responsibility to square his faith with the facts," we urge our neo-evangelical friends to consider these further developments of dispensational truth without delay, to determine whether the decline in fundamentalism is indeed largely due to its espousal of

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[15] *Op. Cit.,* P. 31.
[16] And Dr. Smith was chosen to take part in the revision of the *Scofield Reference Bible!*

dispensationalism or whether it is not rather due to its failure to go on in dispensational truth.

What is it that caused God's special message for this dispensation to be buried, during the dark ages, under ecclesiastical dogma? What has caused its recovery to be resisted and fought every step of the way? What, still today, causes the leaders of the Church to hinder its full recovery by opposing truths that are so obvious and clear in the Scriptures?

It is true, to be sure, that many of the leaders among fundamentalists do not clearly *understand* the great message revealed to and through the Apostle Paul, but why do they not understand it? Are they lacking in intelligence? Have we not yet come far enough along in dispensational truth for them to understand Paul's teachings regarding "the mystery"? Is God unwilling to grant to His saints the light on His Word so sorely needed in these crucial times? No. Our Lord gives the answer in John 7:17:

"If any man willeth to do His will, he shall know of the teaching" (R.V.).

It is self-will that always has, and still does, stand in the way, for even the hosts of darkness cannot bar the entrance of light into the heart of the one who seeks to understand the truth *in order that he might do God's will.* There it is in the words of Christ on earth, which we are frequently charged with repudiating: Let a man truly desire to do God's will and the knowledge of the doctrine will not be withheld.

THROWING AWAY THE KEY

Discarding dispensationalism as a method of interpretation, the neo-evangelicals have thrown away the golden key that unlocks the Scriptures. Their reaction to fundamentalist failures has led them down the wrong road.

There can be no question that there has been a retreat from Dr. Scofield's dispensational position among recognized fundamentalist leaders, and apparently they do not wish to consider the possibility that they may be going in the wrong direction.[17] They are more zealous to be orthodox than to be Scriptural. They have determined not to go beyond the teachings of the "fathers": Darby, Scofield, Gaebelein, Ironside--and thus have actually departed from the best that these men taught. This, essentially, is what has produced neo-evangelicalism.

Thus fundamentalists as a class have ceased going forward in the truth. But those who do not go forward go inexorably backward, so that many who once felt they had reached the summit of dispensational truth have now fallen back into Amillennialism and Pentecostalism, and others, who still hold generally to Scofield's position are beginning to ask whether, after all, we might not have to go through the prophesied tribulation or at least through part of it.

[17] See the author's book, *The Controversy.*

The results of the fundamentalist retreat are evident on every hand, and not least in the teachings of neo-evangelicalism. While the neo-evangelicals claim that in matters of eschatology they are "purposely vague," they are prone to make the grossest blunders when they do make specific statements regarding God's plan for the ages.

For example, the *Christianity Today* for January 21, 1966, carries an editorial by Carl Henry, leading neo-evangelical, titled, *Evangelize: The Order of the Day.* Regarding the worsening conditions of this present age Dr. Henry in this article says: "Still, the gospel as a witness to the approaching kingdom will be preached" and "Let evangelicals not only proclaim redemption in the face of impending judgment but also 'preach, saying, the Kingdom of heaven is at hand.' Never was evangelism more needed than in this apocalyptic age."

This appeal squares with Nash's declaration that "the non-dispensationalist usually finds eschatological factors least important"![18]

Evidently Dr. Henry has forgotten or has never noticed that the earthly establishment of the kingdom, which was proclaimed "at hand" during our Lord's earthly ministry, will not be at hand again until certain predicted signs appear. See our Lord's words in Luke 21:25-31:

"And there shall be signs in the sun, and in the moon, and in the stars; and upon the earth distress of nations, with perplexity; the sea and the waves roaring;

"Men's hearts failing them for fear, and for looking after those things which are coming on the earth: for the powers of heaven shall be shaken.

"And then shall they see the Son of man coming in a cloud with power and great glory,

"And when these things begin to come to pass, then look up, and lift up your heads; for your redemption draweth nigh.

"And he spake to them a parable; Behold the fig tree, and all the trees;

"When they now shoot forth, ye see and know of your own selves that summer is now nigh at hand.

"So likewise ye, when ye see these things come to pass, know ye that the kingdom of God is nigh at hand."

The kingdom, which was *promised* by the Old Testament prophets (Jer. 23:5, *et al.) was proclaimed at hand* by John the Baptist, our Lord and the twelve (Matt. 3:1,2; 4:17; 10:5-7). It was *offered* by Peter (Acts 3:19-21) after our Lord's ascension, but has been *held in abeyance* ever since Israel's rejection of the

[18] *The New Evangelicalism,* P. 168.

testimony of Pentecost (Rom. 11:25). Finally it will be *established* when Messiah returns to "turn away ungodliness from Jacob" (Rom. 11:26,27,29).

The present economy during which the earthly establishment of the kingdom is being held in abeyance is called *"the dispensation of the grace of God"* (Eph. 3:1,2). This dispensation had *never been* prophesied. It was a "mystery," kept secret until the glorified Lord revealed it to that *other* apostle, *Paul* (Ver. 3; cf. Tit. 1:3). The gospel to be proclaimed during this dispensation is *"the gospel of the grace of God," "the word of reconciliation"* (Acts 20:24; II Cor. 5:14-21). This is the message men need more than ever as the day of grace draws to a close and the world heads toward the "great tribulation." Nowhere in the epistles of Paul do we read of "the gospel as a witness to the approaching kingdom." Nowhere are we instructed to "preach, saying, the kingdom of heaven is at hand."

Dr. Henry's appeal to preach this "gospel" is but one evidence of the deep confusion into which neo-evangelicalism has plunged many who set out to "revitalize" fundamentalism while refusing to face up to dispensational truths dealing with God's message for the world today and His program for the Church today.

This is why many of our readers are praying earnestly that God will soon provide for a coast-to-coast broadcast through which the masses can hear the *unadulterated* "gospel of the grace of God" and the glories of the mystery revealed through Paul, a message of which they have been deprived far too long.

Chapter III

THE NEW EVANGELICALISM AND INTELLECTUALISM

THE LACK OF FUNDAMENTALIST SCHOLARSHIP

In this volume we expect, with God's help, to deal with the new evangelicalism as it relates to the fundamentals of the faith, to science, to social concern, to the doctrine of separation from the world and apostate religion and to Scriptural evangelism.

First, however, we must deal with a phase of the subject which takes us to the very heart of the neo-evangelical movement and explains to a great degree why it poses such grave dangers to the Church.

Complaining of a dearth of competent scholarship among fundamentalists, even in the early days, Ronald Nash quotes the following statement from Norman F. Furniss' book, *The Fundamentalist Controversy.*

"Except for J. Gresham Machen and a few others, the conservatives had no leader with an impressive training ...."[19]

Nash also cites the opinions of others, including Henry and Clark, with regard to "a sterility of fundamentalist scholarship" and "its lack of competent scholarship in such areas as philosophy, sociology, science and politics.[20]

But after World War II, says Nash, a change took place, for at that time a "'younger generation' began to make itself known in theological circles," many of whom "had studied in such centers of intellectual learning as Harvard and Yale."[21]

This is supposed to have brought about the change in evangelical theology reported by *Christian Life* in March, 1956, with its "shift away from so-called dispensationalism" and "an increased emphasis on scholarship."[22]

WHAT SAITH THE SCRIPTURE?

If we are to consider this problem in the light of the Scriptures let us begin by acknowledging the basic validity of Nash's criticism. Intellectuals among Bible-believing fundamentalists have indeed always constituted a minority. But lest the neo-evangelicals attempt to change this situation too drastically they should

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[19] *The New Evangelicalism,* by Nash, P. 26.
[20] *Ibid.,* P. 25-31.
[21] *Ibid.,* P. 29.
[22] *Ibid.,* P. 31.

consider some very important words on the subject in I Cor. 1:26-29, where the Apostle Paul declares by divine inspiration:

"For ye see your calling, brethren, how that not many wise men after the flesh, not many mighty, not many noble, are called:"

Before we complete this passage from the Word of God, let us pause to consider two important details in these opening words.

First, the apostle declares that "not *many* wise men... are called." He does not say, "not *any,"* for faith in the Word of God is by no means to be equated with ignorance. Indeed, some of the most objective and astute thinkers have become the most devout believers in the Bible as the Word of God.

Dr. Henry admits that in the early days of fundamentalism "scholars who were still partisan to biblical supernaturalism were unwelcome at the universities, colleges, and seminaries in which the newer philosophies had made gains."[23] Those in control of these institutions of learning were not as interested in objectively considering all sides of the question as in propagating their own views.

In this respect times have not changed. The intellectuals of any age, it seems, are those who agree with each other that they are intellectual, and they are all too apt to ridicule the views of their "unintellectual" opponents rather than give them a hearing.

The second detail to be noted in I Cor. 1:26 is that "not many wise men *after the flesh . . .* are called." This is important indeed, for in the final analysis who is truly the wiser, the scullery maid who has heeded God's Word, faced her need of Christ and has trusted in Him to save her, or the philosopher or scientist who ignores God's claim and has never even stopped to face the question: "What will finally become of me?"

But the remainder of Paul's great passage in I Corinthians 1 indicates that "the dearth of scholarship" among Bible-believing Christians is not entirely due to any failure on their part.

"But God hath CHOSEN the foolish things of the world to confound the wise; and God hath CHOSEN the weak things of the world to confound the things that are mighty;

"And base things of the world, and things which am despised, hath God CHOSEN, yea, and things which am not, to bring to nought the things that are,"

Mark well, this passage does not say merely that God is willing to accept the foolish, or to bear with them. It says He has *chosen* them, to confound the wise--and for a very valid reason:

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[23] *Fifty Years of Protestant Theology,* P. 89.

“THAT NO FLESH SHOULD GLORY [BOAST] IN HIS PRESENCE."

Verse 21 of the same passage makes it clear that it was "*in the wisdom of God"* that "the world by wisdom knew not God," i.e., in His sovereign wisdom He did not *permit* the world to come to know Him by its wisdom.

Thus Luke 10:21 inform us that our Lord, whose teachings were despised by the intellectual leaders of His day, but welcomed by the lowly:

"... rejoiced in spirit, and said, I thank Thee, O Father, Lord of heaven and earth, that thou hast hid these things from the wise and prudent, and hast revealed them unto babes: even so, Father, for so it seemed good in Thy sight."

The truth of these declarations is seen on every hand, for it is clearly *not* in the world's halls of learning that men are coming to know God. Thus, not only does the Bible declare that "the wisdom of this world is foolishness with God";[24] it also demonstrates how the wisdom of this world has failed to meet man's greatest need---a need so gloriously met by "the preaching of the Cross"--and hurls the challenge: *"Where is the wise? where is the scribe? where is the disputer of this world? hath not God made foolish the wisdom of this world?”*[25]

In this connection it is interesting to observe that the "brain trusts" and their "egg heads" in American politics have certainly not compared favorably with some of our more homespun political leaders.

DOWNGRADING FUNDAMENTALIST SCHOLARSHIP

It is a fact that there have always been some, fundamentalists included, who have scorned learning and education. The Book of Proverbs takes such to task and exposes their folly.

But Nash implies that fundamentalists *as a class* have been guilty of presumptuous ignorance. Decrying what he calls fundamentalism's "depreciation of scholarship in all fields",[26] he quotes further from the passage by Furhiss:

"Ignorance, then, was a feature of the movement; it became a badge the orthodox often wore proudly. They believed . . . that higher education was of limited value, even a handicap in seeking the kingdom.”[27]

The first sentence in this statement is surely a gross exaggeration, nor is it the very loftiest form of debate to dismiss the other side of an argument by Simply declaring, without substantiating evidence, that one's opponents are ignorant and proud of it. Unhappily Nash and Furhiss are not alone in yielding to this temptation.

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[24] I Cor. 3:19. Note: The reference here is not to the world's *knowledge,* but to its *wisdom, the application* of the knowledge it has gained.
[25] I Cor. 1:20.
[26] *Op. Cit.,* P. 26.
[27] *Op. Cit.,* P. 26.

Robert P. Lightner has rightly objected to this failure in neo-evangelical writings, citing Edward J. Carnell's *Case for Orthodoxy as* one volume "given over to a large extent to the downgrading of the fundamentalist intellectualism."[28]

In this matter our neo-evangelical brethren should take care not to emulate the modernists of a few generations ago. This writer well remembers noting in the liberal publications of the day the tiresome recurrence of such phrases as, "All scholarship is agreed . . . ," "No person of intellect would accept . . . ," and "Every representative thinker holds .... "Yet almost the only heed these "scholars" and "representative thinkers" paid to those who disagreed with their philosophies was to hold them up to ridicule. Actually it was they who deserved to be ridiculed, for, casting aside the Word of God they now found themselves drifting on an open sea of conflicting human opinions and speculations with no authoritative voice to turn to for wisdom, yet all the while they continued to occupy the sacred lectern as men of God!

This writer knows several neo-evangelicals who were companions of his youth. He did not realize at that time that their intellectual capacities were so much greater than his, but the time has come when he feels like calling, even from afar off: "Hello there! Remember me? I'm Neill Stam!"

THE RELATIVE VALUE OF HIGHER EDUCATION

However, this may be, the greatest intellectual who is also a regenerated believer will readily agree that higher education *is* "of *limited* value" and *sometimes* even "a handicap" in seeking what Furniss calls "the kingdom."

By and large the educators of this world's universities are unregenerate men. They clearly show that they have not experienced what St. Paul calls "the renewing of your minds." They still consider the Bible in the light of other things while we consider other things in the light of the Bible---from God's viewpoint.

How can we learn spiritual truth from men who, whatever their intellectual attainments, still remain in darkness as to the most vital matters, and need the Holy Spirit to "open their eyes, and to turn them from darkness to light and from the power of Satan unto God"?[29]

Thus "higher education" is indeed of limited value to the believer, and sometimes even a handicap, for how many promising young men have made shipwreck of the faith in the world's colleges and seminaries! Surely the evangelical Bible-believer should be the first to recognize this and to humbly bear in mind that "the fear of the Lord is the *beginning* of wisdom."[30]

INTELLECTUALISM NOT THE ANSWER

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[28] *Neo-Evangelicalism,* by Lightner, P. 76.
[29] Acts 26:18
[30] Prov. 9:10

To "put the shoe on the other foot," then, we believe that the neo-evangelicals, as a class, have placed too much emphasis on intellectualism as a remedy for fundamentalism's malady.

Dr. Harold J. Ockenga has declared that one aim of the neo-evangelical is "to win a new respectability for orthodoxy in the academic circles by producing scholars who can defend the faith on intellectual ground."[31]

Does this desire to win a "new respectability" for orthodoxy betray a reluctance to bear the reproach of Bible-believing fundamentalism? Perhaps when Dr. Ockenga wrote the above he forgot that Paul, with all his intellectual acumen, never won respectability for the faith among the scholars of his day. Rather, the intellectuals of learning's capital disdained him, its ruder members mocking him, while others, coolly courteous, dismissed him by saying: "We will hear thee again on this matter."[32]

Nash argues that "the evangelical believes that the most important task in the world (the propagation and defense of the gospel) requires the best possible preparation .... "[33] This is true as far as it goes, but we must ask, "preparation *in what?"* Nash answers this question for himself in the same passage, where he says:

"The evangelical desires to study philosophy and science so that he might defend the Christian faith .... " "The evangelical pleads for more dedicated Christians who are trained in the arts and sciences and who can show the relevance of the Christian message for their respective areas of specialization .... "

Neo-evangelicals seem to think that this is the need of the hour, while in fact there is a far greater need in the Church for pastors who are grounded in the Word and will teach the Bible to the spiritually hungry multitudes.

Our neo-evangelical brethren overlook the fact that while an intellectual believer might back an unbeliever into a corner and tie him up in knots with logical and philosophical arguments until he cries: "I give up! You are right and I am wrong,"-- *this will not save his soul.* Salvation is the result of *faith* in *God's Word* as the Holy Spirit, its Author, applies it to the heart.

"For the Word of God is living and powerful, and sharper than any two-edged sword, piercing even to the dividing asunder of soul and spirit, and of the joints and marrow, and is a discerner of the thoughts and intents of the heart.

"Neither is there any creature that is not manifest in His sight: but all things are naked and open unto the eyes of Him with whom we have to do."[34]

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[31] "Resurgent Evangelical Leadership," *Christianity Today,* Oct., 1960.
[32] Acts 17:32
[33] *Op. cit., P. 148.*
[34] Heb. 4:12, 13

"Being born again, not of corruptible seed, but of incorruptible, by the Word of God, which liveth and abideth for ever."[35]

It is *first of all* then, a thorough knowledge of the Scriptures, not a knowledge of "the arts and sciences," that we need to bring the lost, even the intellectual lost, to salvation in Christ.

Does this mean, then, that men trained in the arts and sciences cannot use their secular knowledge to good advantage in winning their colleagues to Christ? No. Indeed they *can* use it to *great* advantage, but *only in the measure that they are also grounded in the Scriptures.* It is all a matter of emphasis, and from what this writer has read of neo-evangelical writings they have placed the emphasis in *the wrong place.* It is largely upon the need for "dedicated Christians" to become "trained in the arts and sciences," whereas it should be upon dedicated Christians, whatever their calling, becoming well grounded in the Scriptures so that they might be productive in Christ's service, *"approved unto God… workmen who need not to be ashamed, rightly dividing the Word of truth."*[36]

THE PASSION FOR INTELLECTUALISM
A GRAVE DANGER

We have seen from the Scriptures, that a mere emphasis on intellectualism is not the answer to the problem of a stagnant Church, but we must see further the positive harm that may come to the Church by an over-emphasis on intellectualism.

We have before us Dr. Carl Henry's recent book, *Frontiers in Modern Theology,* "A Critique of Current Theological Trends," published by *Moody Press* of Chicago. Dr. Henry contends for conservative theology on intellectual ground, and his motives are doubtless commendable. However, one would expect this book to expose modern theology to the light of the Scriptures, or perhaps to Scripture *and* reason, but this it does not do. Rather, the book is filled with philosophical reasonings about past and current schools of theological thought, couched in language that all too few can understand. Though it contains only 155 pages it refers to, or quotes from, no less than 170 individual writers, many of them several times, while only .the barest few Scripture passages are even referred to.

According to the publishers Henry's critique is designed "to prod American evangelicals to interact with the pressing problems of Protestant thought in our time," but it certainly gives them no Scripture to interact with, and it is our understanding that the Scriptures were given to fully equip "the man of God" where "doctrine…reproof... correction" and "instruction in righteousness" are concerned.[37]

It may be argued that evangelical pastors should be abreast of all the current theological trends so as to be able to deal with them effectively. We question this.

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[35] I Peter 1:23
[36] II Tim. 2:15
[37] II Tim. 3:16,17.

Why let "every wind of doctrine"---and there are many--keep us always on the defensive? This is exactly the mistake which America has made politically in its dealings with Communism, and always at our expense.

Let us rather *"preach the Word"* as we are instructed, using *it to* "feed the flock of God" and using *it,* likewise, to refute heresies *when we are confronted with them.*

To be so widely and thoroughly conversant with the writings of so many philosophers and theologians Dr. Henry has had to sacrifice a great deal of time from his study of the Word of God. No alternative view is possible here for each of us has just so much time and strength and we who have been called to the ministry of the Word do well to take this constantly to heart, so that we may never fail to put first things first.

But Dr. Henry is not alone in all this for many books by neo-evangelical writers are filled with “heavy," often ambiguous reasoning, abounding with "jawbreakers" such as contemporaneity, dialectic existentialism, demythologize, kerygmatic and pre-suppositionalism, while the Scriptures are consigned to second place.

In all this display of intellectualism, we fear, the writers, not Christ, are receiving the glory. It was exactly such intellectual display that the Apostle Paul, himself a man of great intellect, repudiated in the strongest terms. Hear his words on this subject as found in his First Epistle to the Corinthians:

"For Christ sent me not to baptize, but to preach the gospel: NOT WITH WISDOM OF WORDS, LEST THE CROSS OF CHRIST SHOULD BE MADE OF NONE EFFECT" (1:17),

"And I, brethren, when I came to you, came NOT WITH EXCELLENCY OF SPEECH or of wisdom . . ." (2:1)

"And my speech and my preaching was NOT WITH ENTICING [PERSUASIVE] WORDS OF MAN'S WISDOM, but in demonstration of the Spirit and of power.

“THAT YOUR FAITH SHOULD NOT STAND IN THE WISDOM OF MEN, BUT IN THE POWER OF GOD" (2:4,5).

"For our rejoicing is this, the testimony of our conscience, that IN SIMPLICITY AND GODLY SINCERITY, NOT WITH FLESHLY WISDOM, BUT BY THE GRACE OF GOD, we have had our conversation in the world, and more abundantly to you-ward" (II Cor. 1:12).

It is disappointing, then, to find our neo-evangelical brethren so eager to be intellectual that, even where philosophy and theology are concerned, they appear to stand in awe before the wisdom of this world, which God calls "foolishness."

They are pleased to report that neo-evangelicalism is "fundamentalism becoming intellectual," that we now have a "younger generation" from such intellectual centers as "Harvard and Yale," who are "able to view other kinds of theology more objectively and appreciatively than their predecessors ...."[38] Note the word "appreciatively"! These young intellectuals are better able to *appreciate* the teachings of apostates than were their predecessors!

One basic difference, then, between the neo-evangelical and the true fundamentalist is this: The neo-evangelical attempts to convince unregenerate intellectuals on intellectual ground that the Bible is "the Word of God . . . living, and powerful, and sharper than any two-edged sword," while the fundamentalist, believing on intellectual and other grounds that the Bible is the Word of God, "the Sword of the Spirit," *uses it* to convict men of sin and bring them to Christ for salvation.

Surely the authors of such works as we have mentioned above are barely getting "the Sword of the Spirit" out of its scabbard in combatting apostasy. Rather they are using the ineffective weapon of philosophical reasoning.

This brings to the writer's mind a strange admission by Dr. Henry. On Page 141 of his *Frontiers in Modern Theology* he states: "Theology textbooks a half century old sometimes offer more solid content than the more recent tracts-for-the-times.... "As we leaf through some of the older theology textbooks in our own library we feel that we know the reason. These men of God *used the Scriptures* in their discussions rather than only writing about them.

We beseech our neo-evangelical brethren, therefore, to cast down the idol Intellectualism and get back to expository teaching of the Word of God. There is nothing that will win the unbeliever like *the Word taught and rightly divided.* Nor is there anything that will delight the heart of the believer like *the Word taught and rightly divided.*

INTELLECTUAL PRIDE

William E. Ashbrook stirred up a hornet's nest some years ago, when he charged that neo-evangelicalism is "a movement nurtured on pride of intellect," and declared that its leading advocates "are trying very, very hard to be accepted among 'the upper four hundred.'"[39] The neo-evangelicals appear to be very sensitive on this point.

Nash replies to Ashbrook's charge by making a series of statements as to neo-evangelical aims and repeating after each statement the question: "Is this pride of intellect?"[40]

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[38] Arnold Hearn in "Fundamentalist Renascence," *Christian Century* Apr. 30, 1958.
[39] *The New Neutralism, P. 20.*
[40] *Op. cit*., Pp. 148. 149.

But from what we have seen earlier Nash should at least concede that where intellectualism is concerned there is a great tendency to become lifted up with pride.

Only God can make a brain and keep it in working order. We can but *use* it for as long as He lends it to us. Yet we are all prone to become puffed up with pride and to look down upon others about us if we possess a fairly good model that works reasonably well! Indeed, among the ungodly the mind is considered the highest court of appeal!

It is therefore this display of intellect among the neo-evangelicals that disturbs us, for we believe it is offensive to God and detrimental to His cause.

Wishing to be broad and open-minded the neo-evangelicals place themselves and their followers in grave spiritual danger.

On the basis that they are mature and sincerely desirous of making an impact in intellectual circles, their young students and pastors are apt to spend most of their time examining all the current theological innovations while neglecting the study of the Scriptures themselves. This is just how many a prospective pastor has made shipwreck of the faith or at best has graduated from seminary ill-prepared to expound the Word.

We should be careful about assuming that we are mature, either intellectually or spiritually. To the puffed-up Corinthian believers Paul wrote:

"Let no man deceive himself. If any man among you seemeth to be wise in this world, let him become [take the position of] a fool, that he may be wise" (I Cor. 3:18).

The desire to examine and appraise all schools of thought may seem superficially to indicate spiritual greatness but actually it is of the flesh and is based upon the exalted presumption that it is safe for *me* to trust *my* intellect even though the greatest intellects have disagreed over the most vital subjects. Where our intellects are concerned we are wiser to heed the Spirit-inspired exhortation of one truly great intellect: Paul, in his second letter to the Corinthians.

"Casting down imaginations, and every high thing that exalteth itself against the knowledge of God, and bringing into captivity every thought to the obedience of Christ" (10:5).

If Robert Young and several other scholars of the Greek are correct, the italicized words "of himself" and "of men" in Rom. 12:3 and I Cor. 4:6 respectively, should have been omitted rather than supplied by the A.V. translators. These verses would then read:

"For I say, through the grace given unto me, to every man that is among you, not to think more highly than he ought to think; but to think soberly, according as God hath dealt to every man the measure of faith."

"... that ye might learn in us not to think above that which is written, that no one of you be puffed up for one against another."

Paul did not assume that his followers were mature enough to consider all religious viewpoints. He did not suggest to the Ephesian elders that they invite heterodox teachers to engage with them in dialogue. He rather impressed upon them their responsibility to *protect* their congregations from false teaching. Read carefully and prayerfully his earnest exhortation in Acts 20:28-32. Note too how he beseeches even Timothy, that gifted and devoted man of God, in I Tim. 6:20:

"O Timothy, keep [guard] that which is committed to thy trust, AVOIDING . . . oppositions of science falsely so called."

THE VALUE OF TRUE WISDOM

Getting away from the subject of intellectualism and scholarship to a more vital consideration, surely no true fundamentalist will depreciate the value of true *wisdom.* Rather he will heartily agree with the words of Prov. 4:7-9:

"Wisdom is the principal thing; therefore get wisdom: and with all thy getting get understanding,

"Exalt her, and she shall promote thee: she shall bring thee to honor, when thou dost embrace her.

"She shall give to thine head an ornament of grace: a crown of glory shall she deliver to thee."

This proverb receives added emphasis when we consider that the word "get," in Verse 7, means to acquire or to buy. In Prov. 23:23 we find the same Hebrew word so translated:

"Buy the truth and sell it net; also wisdom, and instruction**,** and understanding."

In other words, "wisdom is the principal thing," and we should be willing to pay the price, whatever it may be, to acquire it: long hours of study and painstaking research, humble acceptance of instruction, denial of pleasures that others enjoy, physical weariness, financial loss.

To any who would question this and argue that the humblest believer is better off than the wisest sage without God, we reply that a man without God is *not* wise. It is "the fool" who says in his heart, *"No God,"* and "the fear of the Lord is the *beginning o*f wisdom."[41]

[41] Psa. 14:1; Prov. 9:10.

From all this we conclude that (1) The fear of the Lord is basic to all true wisdom and, (2) The knowledge of God (theology in its broader sense) is the most important study in which we can possibly engage. All else revolves around this and must be viewed in its light.

It was when the now-pagan world failed to recognize and glorify God that they "became vain in their imaginations, and their foolish heart was darkened," so that "professing themselves to be wise, they became fools."[42]

Thus it is that the Apostle Paul says in Phil. 3:8: "I count all things but loss for the *excellency* of the knowledge of Christ Jesus my Lord." The wisdom he now proclaimed far surpassed anything that this world, or its institutions of learning, could offer. The apostle has much to say about this in his epistles.

After challenging the world's intellectuals to compare the results of their scholarship with those which "the preaching of the cross" produces, he says in I Cor. 1:22-24:

"For the Jews require a sign and the Greeks seek after wisdom:

"But we preach Christ crucified; unto the Jews a stumblingblock, and unto the Greeks foolishness;

"But unto them which are called, both Jews and Greeks, CHRIST THE POWER OF GOD, AND THE WISDOM OF GOD."

Paul's "preaching of the cross," of course, included more, much more, than the fact that "Christ died for our sins." It included the believer's identification with Christ, his baptism into our Lord's death, burial and resurrection, and so into Christ Himself and into His Body. It included a heavenly position and "all spiritual blessings" in Christ, and *all* that His crucifixion had purchased for believers. It is in connection with these riches of His grace that the apostle prays in Eph. 1:17,18:

"That the God of our Lord Jesus Christ, the Father of glory, may give unto you the spirit of wisdom and revelation in the knowledge of Him;

"The eyes of your understanding being enlightened, that ye may know .... "

This wonderful message of grace and glory proclaimed by Paul is called "the mystery," or "secret," both because it was kept secret until the glorified Lord revealed it through him, and because it is the secret of all God's dealings with mankind and of His eternal purpose in Christ. Thus the apostle closes his great Epistle to the Romans with these words:

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[42] Rom. 1:21,22.

"Now to Him that is of power to establish you according to MY GOSPEL, and THE PREACHING OF JESUS CHRIST ACCORDING TO THE REVELATION OF THE MYSTERY, which was kept secret since the world began" (Ver. 25).

This is the particular message which the apostle spent himself to make known, "admonishing every man and teaching every man in all wisdom," that they might become mature in Christ, enjoying "all the riches of *the full assurance of understanding"* and might fully comprehend "the mystery of God, even Christ, in Whom are all the treasures of wisdom and knowledge hidden."[43]

But here our intellectual neo-evangelical brethren show up poorly, for as a class they seem sadly ignorant of the very message by which believers of this dispensation are to be established in the faith.

Ignoring all the clear Scriptures which emphasize the distinctive character of Paul's apostleship and message, Dr. Harold J. Ockenga, the reputed "father of neo-evangelicalism," declares that "only one gospel is taught by all the writers of the New Testament, including Paul."[44]

This is strange in the light of the fact that in the New Testament Scriptures we read of "the gospel of the kingdom," "the gospel of the circumcision," "the gospel of the uncircumcision," "the gospel of the grace of God," etc. Does a housewife label the various preserves in her cupboard with *different* labels because they *are all the same!* Would they prove appetizing if she mixed them all up together? Yet this is exactly what Dr. Ockenga has done with the various "gospels" of the New Testament.

But Dr. Ockenga's statement is the more strange when we take note that Paul again and again designates his special message as "my gospel," "that gospel which was preached of me," "that gospel which I preach among the Gentiles," etc.

Thus our brother has not only misread Paul's statement in Gal. 1:8,9 about "any other gospel," but he has failed to see in it a warning of the grave consequences of now preaching any other gospel than that which *Paul* preached.

This is the sad result of the neo-evangelicals' "shift away from so-called dispensationalism" and its "increased emphasis on scholarship."

The story is told of a railroad conductor who was forced to tell the nice young couple in the first seat that they were on the wrong train. The best thing to do now would be to get off at the next stop and go back to the place from which they had started. It was not until the conductor had gotten half way up the aisle that it dawned on him that it was not they, it was *he* who was on the wrong train!

This, we feel, is the situation with the leaders of neo-evangelicalism and it is our prayer that before they tell too many fundamentalists that they are on the wrong

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[43] Col. 1:28; 2:2,3 (R.V.). See the author's book: *The Knowledge of the Mystery.*
[44] "Church With a Global Shadow," *World Vision,* March. 1964.

train, they will see their mistake and start over. The analogy fails at one point, however, for we want them to stay on the train with the fundamentalists!

AN EARNEST PRAYER

As this writer considers the possibilities and pitfalls of the human intellect, he offers this earnest prayer:

"God give me *intelligence,* the ability to think clearly.

“Give me the *knowledge* of all that is good for me to know, that I may be 'wise unto that which is good, and simple concerning evil.'

"Give me *perception,* that delicate sense of awareness that observes what others fail to see.

"Give me a penetrating *insight,* that sees beneath the surface and uncovers the heart of a matter.

"Give me a *discriminating mind,* that notes fine lines of distinction and delicate shades of meaning.

"Give me keen *discernment,* to detect the difference between that which is false and that which is true, between that which is dangerous and that which is safe.

"Give me good *judgment,* to make sound decisions.

"Give me true *wisdom,* the ability to use all I know with unusually good sense. 'For wisdom is better than rubies; and all the things that may be desired are not to be compared to it.'

"And above all, give me *'spiritual understanding'* to comprehend Thy Word, for I know that 'the natural man receiveth not the things of the Spirit of God... because they are spiritually discerned.'

"This prayer we pray in the name of the Lord Jesus Christ, *'in whom are hid all the treasures of wisdom and knowledge.''*

But when we come to the word *intellectualism* something troubles us. We sincerely thank God for every true man of intellect, who is able to think on a higher plane of intelligence than those about him. Yet it seems to us that on the whole intellectuals are born, not made, and that it is a grievous mistake to *try* to be intellectual.

We have consulted both *Webster's* and *Funk and Wagnall's* 1965 unabridged dictionaries on this subject and feel we understand more fully what it is about the word *intellectualism* that troubles us.

Webster's defines *intellectualism* thus: "1. Intellectuality. 2. In philosophy, the doctrine that all knowledge is derived from the intellect." *Funk and Wagnall's* definitions of this word are practically identical.

Consistently *Webster's* first definition of *intellectualist* is: "One who overrates the understanding" and *Funk and Wagnall's* defines it: "1. *Metaph.* An adherent of intellectualism. 2. One who overrates the understanding."

On the basis of the above--well, we suppose we will just have to plead guilty to the oft-repeated charge of *anti-intellectualism.*

Chapter IV

THE NEW EVANGELICALISM AND THE FUNDAMENTALS OF THE FAITH

NEO-EVANGELICAL CLAIMS

Neo-evangelicals in general do not wish to be called fundamentalists, but they do want fundamentalists to be assured that they stand for all the fundamentals of the Christian faith.

They are essentially opposed, they point out, not to the fundamentalist's faith but to his "lack of scholarship," his "extreme separatism," his lack of a sense of social responsibility and his dispensationalism.

We have already noted some neo-evangelical claims to orthodoxy, and such claims by its champions could doubtless fill many pages.

We have already pointed out that Ronald H. Nash in his *New Evangelicalism,* says:

"... the evangelical is as anxious to defend the great verities of the Christian faith as any fundamentalist."[45]

"The evangelical is as against liberalism in its many forms as ever."[46]

"... they are unquestioning in their allegiance to the Bible as the inscripturated revelation of God."[47]

Quoting from an article in *Christian Life,* Nash says of neo-evangelicalism: "It's still as concerned over preserving the Christian essentials as were the early fundamentalists."[48]

Likewise, quoting from an article by Dr. Harold J. Ockenga: *"In* doctrine the evangelicals and the fundamentalists are one … [They] could sign the same creed."[49]

Similar claims are made by other neo-evangelical leaders and we do not question that they are sincerely on the side of orthodoxy as opposed to neo-orthodoxy and liberalism. What we question is whether their zeal for scholarship

[45] P. 92.
[46] *Ibid.,* P. 96.
[47] *Ibid*., P. 176.
[48] *Ibid.,* P. 32.
[49] *Ibid.,* P. 176.

and dialogue with liberal apostates has indeed left them *"as* anxious to defend the great verities of the Christian faith as any fundamentalist." or *"as* against liberalism . . . as ever."

It is our purpose in these pages to examine the validity of these claims.

NEO-EVANGELICAL CLAIMS QUESTIONED

In his preface to *The New Evangelicalism,* Nash says:

"Furthermore, the contrast between evangelicalism and present tendencies within the Lutheran and Reformed churches is neither as clear-cut nor as important as that separating evangelical into from fundamentalism."

When one considers the present tendencies to liberalism in these two denominations, it is disappointing that Nash finds these "neither as clear-cut *nor as important"* as the *"contrast . . . separating* evangelicalism from fundamentalism" (emphasis ours).

He is no doubt correct in stating that "There are hosts of Reformed, Presbyterian and Lutheran Christians" who "maintain their theological orthodoxy,"[50] but their presence in these denominations does not mitigate the seriousness of the "present tendencies" toward apostasy, and it speaks volumes that Nash and other neo-evangelicals feel themselves closer to denominations which embrace false doctrine, than to fundamental believers who may not see eye-to-eye with them as to methods of evangelism.

How lightly Nash views liberalism's apostasy from the Word of God is clearly seen in the fact that he looks upon Christ-denying apostates as members of the Body of Christ. Consider for example the following "accusation":

"Evangelicalism accuses twentieth-century separatism of departing from the New Testament doctrine of the Church, particularly, its teaching of the organic and spiritual unity of the Body of Christ.

*"...*The separatists left whole denominations, together with their seminaries, churches and agencies, in the hands of the liberals. We are not denying that at the time of withdrawal the liberals were in control of these things. But does that mean that every time that the balance of power swings away from us that we should cease being a minority voice? Does this warrant our surrender of the *whole* every time the liberals are in the majority? Now, thirty years later, orthodoxy has little voice within many of these influential areas of the Church."[51]

Nash believes, then, that Bible-believing Christians should continue in fellowship with denominational apostates who deny the very fundamentals of the

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[50] *Ibid.*
[51] *Ibid*., Pp. 94, 95.

Christian faith. Clearly he does not comprehend the gravity of the liberal heresies for be includes all these apostate unbelievers in "the Body of Christ."

Should some readers object that not all neo-evangelicals would go this far, we reply that too many of them do go too far in this direction and that Dr. Harold John Ockenga, "the father of neo-evangelicalism," says of this very book: "One would be hard put to find a book with which he agreed more thoroughly."[52]

This explains why Nash and other neo-evangelicals are so interested in carrying on round table discussions with liberals who deny the very fundamentals of the faith. Nash writes approvingly of a report in *Christian Life* encouraging "a reopening of the subject of biblical inspiration; and a growing willingness on the part of evangelicals to converse with liberal and dialectical theologians."[53]

He himself says: "Evangelicals are more conscious than fundamentalists of the need to carry on an exchange of ideas with liberal and neo-orthodox theologians."[54] Mark well the phrase "exchange of ideas." And he calls this "carrying the gospel to *all* men"![55]

An examination of neo-evangelical views of the sacred Scriptures reveals how unfounded are Nash's claims that the neo-evangelicals are "as anxious to defend the great verities of the Christian faith as any fundamentalist."

Increasingly neo-evangelicals are using the word "adequate" rather than "inerrant" or "infallible" with regard to the inspiration of the Scriptures.

Nash quotes Richard K. Curtis' suggestion: "Would not *adequacy* be a more meaningful designation than 'inerrancy' or 'infallibility'?"[56]

Concerning this statement Nash says he does not believe it is Curtis' *"direct* intention to deny the concept of biblical inerrancy," (our emphasis) and adds: "By this I mean that his argument still leaves it an open question as to whether or not the autographs were inerrant."[57]

Nash does not appear to feel that Curtis is treading on dangerous ground here. Indeed, he himself adds that "The autographs may have been inerrant while later translations and versions are adequate, albeit not perfect…"[58] Note the phrase "may have been."

We all agree that the translations are not inerrant. The question revolves entirely around the original manuscripts, or autographs. Were *they* inerrant? Nash says they "may have been." In other words, perhaps they too were merely

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[52] Testimony on the jacket of *The New Evangelicalism,* by Nash.
[53] *Op.cit.,* P. 31.
[54] *Ibid.,* P. 102.
[55] *Ibid.*
[56] *Ibid.,* P. 66.
[57] *Ibid.*
[58] *Ibid.*

"adequate." Indeed, he seems to harbor this feeling, for he quotes, without criticism, Curtis' statement that "the only absolute in Christianity is the Triune God. Language is only arbitrary, conventionalized symbolization which is subject to constant change."[59]

Referring to the controversy over inspiration between James Orr and H. P. Smith on the one side and Charles Hodge and B. B. Warfield on the other, Nash states that Orr did "admit" the possibility that the Bible contains some historical errors.[60] What can this mean but that Nash also believes this?

Similarly Bernard Ramm calls Hodge to his side to confirm his view that the Bible may contain errors. But he misrepresents Hodge here. Quoting a passage from Hodge's *Systematic Theology* (Volume I, Page 165) at length, Ramm puts in italics those phrases which he feels will help his cause, while failing to emphasize those phrases which clearly oppose his view. Thus he interprets Hodge's meaning as follows:

"Even if there is a proof of error in matters of fact Hodge says it is of no consequence. A few grains of sand in the marble of the Parthenon, he argues, would not cause a man to deny that the Parthenon was made of marble; so, a few errors of matters of fact in the Bible are no grounds for denying the Bible's inspiration."[61]

Ramm seriously misinterprets Hodge here, for Hodge says nothing of the kind. Indeed, in the very paragraph which Ramm quotes, Hodge says that "the sacred writers were infallible . . . for the special purpose for which they were employed .... They were infallible . . . when acting as spokesmen for God .... Isaiah was infallible in his predictions ..." etc. Hodge only points out that the sacred writers were not *otherwise* infallible, and who would argue that they were?

Hodge in this paragraph and its context, does not argue that "if there *is* a proof of error... It is of no consequence," as Ramm says. Hodge does not admit that there is such proof. He rather implies that if there *were* a few such errors, the Bible would still be amazingly free from error, since these would "bear no proportion to the whole." It is a pity that Ramm has so grossly misrepresented Hodge here, for in this whole section of Hodge's *Systematic Theology* he deals fully with *"alleged* discrepancies" and *"apparent* discrepancies" (italics ours). He states that the Scriptures, penned "by men of all degrees of culture, living in the course of fifteen hundred or two thousand years . . . agree perfectly," that they are "miraculously free from the soiling touch of human fingers," etc. As to errors, he refers to *"a* few instances" of "discrepancies which *with our present means of knowledge,* we are unable satisfactorily to explain" (italics ours). But this is far from admitting the presence of error in the Scriptures, and we repeat that if Ramm means only that there are errors in the translations his whole argument is beside the point, for who denies this?

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[59] *Ibid.*
[60] *Ibid.,* Pg. 73.
[61] *The Christian View of Science and Scripture,* P. 118.

Even Nash does not agree with Ramm that Hodge admitted the presence of error in the Scriptures, for he states that Hodge and Warfield asserted that *"a* proved error in Scripture contradicts not only our doctrine, but the Scripture's claim and therefore its inspiration in making those claims."[62]

We agree with Nash, Dr. Wilbur Smith and others that there ought to be a restudy of the subject of Biblical inspiration, for it is by no means a simple subject, and many conservatives as well as liberals entertain confused and inconsistent notions on inspiration. But one simple fact is not to be denied with regard to this subject: If the Scriptures, as written by the inspired penmen, contain errors, then the God of the Bible errs, in which case He is not God.

Nash makes many other weak statements regarding the inspiration of the Scriptures. Among these are the following:

"The Bible is not inspired because it is inerrant. If anything, its inerrancy is the result of its inspiration."[63] Note the "if anything."

"The inerrancy of the autographs is an *assumption,* although the evangelical believes that it is an *important assumption."*[64]

"Most [neo-]evangelicals are convinced that a belief in the inerrancy of the original manuscripts is an important and necessary assumption that remains perfectly consistent with what knowledge we do possess."[65]

In this passage note three important weaknesses. (1) "Most [neo-] evangelicals are convinced .... *"* Evidently *all* are not convinced. (2) The inerrancy of the original manuscripts is an important "assumption." We hold that it is an *inescapable conclusion.* (3) This assumption "remains . . . consistent with what knowledge we do possess." This implies that as we gain further knowledge this assumption *may* no longer be consistently held.

FAITH AND LOVE

As a class the neo-evangelicals emphasize love above doctrine. In this they are too similar to the earlier modernists to give Bible believers a sense of confidence.

Edward John Carnell's writings are a case in point. Camell was a former president of *Fuller Theological Seminary* and one of its instructors. He was a prominent neo-evangelical, who ridiculed fundamentalism while defending theistic evolution.

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[62] *Op. Cit.,,* P. 72.
[63] *Op. Cit.,* P. 76.
[64] *Ibid.,* P. 76.
[65] *Ibid.,* P. 77.

On the basis of John 13:35 Carnell said: "While doctrine illuminates the plan of salvation, the mark of a true disciple is *love,* not doctrine."[66]

Again: "While we must be solicitous about *doctrine*, Scripture says that our primary business is *love*."[67]

Reproving fundamentalists he said: "The test of Christian discipleship was no longer 'works done in love.' The test was 'assent to the fundamentals of the faith.'"[68]

While we confess that with many fundamentalists the possession of truth has been considered a virtue, a matter for boasting, Camell was wrong when he contended that "the mark of a true disciple is *love*, not doctrine,"[69] and that "works done in love" are "the test of Christian discipleship." In this he sounded much like the earlier modernists.

In the first place our Lord, while on earth, proclaimed "the gospel of the *kingdom*," the earthly establishment of His reign. This reign was to be based upon the spontaneous love of each of His followers for the rest. As seen from the Sermon on the Mount it was to be a way of life *on earth* in which all cared for each other and no one needed to be concerned about his own welfare. It was in this context that our Lord said:

"By this shall all men know that ye are My disciples, if ye have love one to another."

How refreshing it is to see our Lord's disciples enjoying this way of life at Pentecost when, all filled with the Holy Spirit,

"... the multitude of them that believed were of one heart and of one soul: neither said any of them that ought of the things which he possessed was his own, but they had all things common."[70]

Thus by their love to each other *the world about them* could tell that they were Christ's *disciples.* But even then their love was not the test of their discipleship and certainly not of their salvation. The true test was faith in God's Word and God's Son as the Gospel records declare:

"He that believeth on the Son hath everlasting life: and he that believeth not the Son shall not see life, but the wrath of God abideth on Him."[71]

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[66] *The Case for Orthodox Theology,* P. 128.
[67] *Ibid.,* P. 121.
[68] "Post-Fundamentalist Faith," *Christianity Today,* Aug. 26, 1959.
[69] We take it he means *faith in* certain doctrines.
[70] Acts 4:32.
[71] John 3:36. See also John 1:12; 3:16-18; 5:24.

The test of true discipleship, then, was *faith,* not love. A believer in Christ might fail to love and he would still be saved, but an unbeliever would not be saved no matter how much he "loved." Thus the test was faith, not love.

It is true that men would be more apt to believe the disciples' *testimony* if they showed love to their brethren, but love alone was not enough. To learn whether a man was Christ's disciple one would still have to ask: *"*Do you *believe* that Jesus is the Christ, the Son of God?"

But the Pentecostal foretaste of the Messianic kingdom has long since passed, and believers *today* are more than *disciples,* or followers, of Christ. The word "disciple," used 272 times in the four Gospels and the Acts is *not used even once in the epistles of Paul.* This is because believers today are members of the "one new man," the *"*Body of Christ," and as such are to express *His* love to those about them, as the hymn says: "Lord lay some soul upon my heart and love that soul through me."

But even in I Cor. 18:13, where love is said to be the "greatest" member of the "abiding trinity," *faith* is still the *first.* It is *faith*, not love, that is of *primary* importance, for *"without faith it is impossible to please God."*[72]

As to doctrine, it is not in the records of our Lord's earthly ministry but in the Pauline epistles that the great doctrines of the faith are developed: the finished work of Christ, reconciliation, justification, identification, sanctification, *et al.* And in these epistles, as we have seen, *faith* and *doctrine* are given the place of primary importance. In this connection the reader should consider carefully such passages as Rom. 6:17; 16:17; Gal. 1:8,9; Eph. 4:14; I Tim. 1:18; 4:16; 6:1-3 and Tit. 2:7.

It is sad, then, to see our neo-evangelical friends place love above faith and doctrine; to see Carnell, for example, give the Word of God a secondary place in his statement: "While we must be solicitous about *doctrine,* Scripture says that our primary business is love."

This harmonizes, though, with two statements made by Carl Henry, the outstanding neo-evangelical of our time. In the first he asks:

"May not evangelical Christianity, dissatisfied with both fundamentalism and modernism, transcend the alternatives of the modernist-fundamentalist controversy?"[73]

In the second he calls neo-evangelicalism "a mediating view... a perspective above the extremes."[74]

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[72] Heb. 11:6
[73] *Evangelical Responsibility In Contemporary Theology*, P. 32.
[74] "The Perils of Independency," *Christianity Today*, Nov. 12, 1956. P. 21.

Does all this sound as if the neo-evangelicals are "as against liberalism in its many forms as ever" or "as anxious to defend the great verities of the faith as any fundamentalist"?

In his *New Evangelicalism* Nash makes one statement about the fundamentalists which also expresses this writer's view: "The fundamentalist is convinced that the evangelical is compromising the faith."[75] If our neo-evangelical friends wish *us* to consider them conservatives they should not give away so much that is vital to true Christianity.

[75] *Op. Cit., P. 96.*

Chapter V

THE NEW EVANGELICALISM AND SCIENCE

AN AMAZING BOOK

What an amazing Book is the Bible! It was written by a succession of Hebrews, living for the most part in a little corner of the world which stood separate and aloof from all the rest. Only Paul appears to have done any extensive traveling, and this only through Asia Minor and Southern Europe. Not only were the writers of the Bible cut off from other nations by their religion (again excepting Paul, the Apostle to the Gentiles) but they belonged to a people who had produced no other book of note except the Bible. It is doubtful whether they *could* have produced anything comparable to the writings of the Greeks and Romans.

Yet these men have given the world a volume which for accuracy, depth of insight, power of influence and adaptability to the needs of man, stands wholly unrivalled!

More than that, its writers were men from the most varied walks of life, including two fishermen, a physician, a herdsman, a tax collector and several kings and statesmen. Yet here is a Book whose unity and harmony are so phenomenal that through the centuries its critics have strained their eyes looking for "contradictions."

How can all this be explained? There is no reasonable explanation except that found in its own claim that *"all Scripture is given by inspiration of God"* (II Tim. 3:16) and that *"holy men of God spake as they were moved by the Holy Spirit"* (II Pet. 1:21).

But all will not accept this explanation.

THE BIBLE BROUGHT INTO QUESTION

Referring to the rise of modernism at the turn of the century, Dr. Howard A. Kelly, of *Johns Hopkins University,* wrote:

"A destructive analysis of the Holy Scriptures, called the Higher Criticism of the Bible, imported from intellectual Germany, was sweeping England, and our own America seemed only too eager to fall into line. The effect of this criticism was to knock out the one great prop of faith by subdividing the Bible into innumerable fragments, or perhaps more literally by tearing it to pieces, while questioning its authenticity and challenging its authority on every page with the rejection of many parts as the myths of a nomadic people. Miracles were discredited because contrary to the laws of nature, and with them logically went the Virgin Birth of

Christ, his Deity, his Atoning Death, his Resurrection and his present mediatorial office at the right hand of the Majesty on High."

"This attitude of a group of exceedingly capable, often personally attractive men, and generally highly trained linguistic scholars, generated such a feeling of uncertainty that multitudes felt that there was no longer any assurance that whenever and wherever one might open the Bible looking for spiritual food he might not find chaff. So widespread a distress only served to demonstrate the imperative demand of the human heart for an absolutely dependable message in so vital a topic as salvation from sin, our universal disease.

"Coincident with this neo-critical development and its vast literature, in the United States there was observable also a profound disturbance of our young people everywhere by two curious phobias… namely, the dread of being called 'unscientific' or 'narrow.' I think that in some degree these bogies still survive in our colleges.

"The destructive criticism, however injurious, could not be lightly brushed aside…"[76]

Dr. Kelly then relates the story of his own examination of the higher critics' claims. The outcome:

"Let me state at once that I am sure that the Bible is the Word of God, with an assurance greater than all other convictions…"

"This positive belief and clear conviction, however, have not been held without due consideration of the positions of the opponents…"[77]

In those days many Christians, including not a few scientists, examined the claims of the higher critics and came out the better for it. In the modernist-fundamentalist battle, it was *not* the modernists, as some claim, but the fundamentalists who won the day. One important factor in this victory was the publication of the *Scofield Reference Bible* in 1909. This edition of the Bible contained many valuable helps but, as we pointed out earlier, the underlying reason for its tremendous influence through the years has been the fact that it was built upon the dispensational principle of interpretation, which Darby, Scofield and others had been emphasizing. In those days fundamentalism made tremendous strides. Millions attended crowded churches and meeting halls where the Bible was expounded, and Bible schools and missionary organizations multiplied as never before. This was true revival!

The sad fact is, however, that the Church, as such, has ceased going forward in the truth. Many have felt that the Darby-Scofield movement brought us to the zenith of truth and that to depart in any particular from what these men taught is to

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[76] *A Scientific Man and the Bible,* by the late Howard A. Kelly, M.D. LL. D., Professor of Gynecological Surgery, *John Hopkins University,* Pp. 28-30.
[77] *Ibid.,* Pp. 41, 42.

be guilty of heresy. Thus, as the neo-evangelicals justly charge, fundamentalism has become stagnant and dead. Indeed, it is this condition that has brought about the rise of neo-evangelicalism, for if we do not go forward in the truth we go inexorably backward.

NEO-EVANGELICALISM
BOWING LOW BEFORE SCIENCE

One who has come to trust the Bible as the Word of God and has recognized the depravity of unregenerate human nature can scarcely contemplate a more pathetic sight than that of Christian leaders bowing low before the scientists of this world.

Science has indeed made many amazing discoveries and has achieved some signal successes, but science, after all, is only what man has found out, or what he thinks he has found out, about the creation which *God* has brought into existence! Yet from the writings of some neo-evangelicals one would suppose that science was far ahead of the Bible and more worthy of our confidence.

Challenging so-called "hyperorthodoxy,' which holds that the Bible, in its original writings, is the inerrant, infallible Word of God, Bernard Ramm asks:

"But would it really believe the Bible if at *every* point the Bible and science conflicted? If the differences between the sciences and the Bible were to grow to a very large number and were of the most serious nature, would it retain faith in Scripture? True, we may believe *some* of the Bible 'in spite of' science, but certainly the situation would change if we believed *all* of the Bible in spite of science."[78]

We trust we may be forgiven for saying that the opening question in this challenge by a so-called "conservative" is not only theoretical; it is foolish.

How could discoveries about *God's* creation conflict with *God's* Word *"at* every point?" And remember, Ramm *does* believe that the Bible is God's Word. So far from conflicting at every point, the perfect harmony between the Bible and true science is becoming more evident year by year.

How often has the Bible anticipated scientific discovery! Indeed it is still doing so in our day. Only a century ago Bible commentators wondered how people in every part of the world could possibly *see* the dead bodies of God's "two witnesses" lying in the street in Jerusalem (Rev. 11:7-9). Those who accepted the Bible as the final authority merely said: "I do not know how this can be, but I believe it will take place because the Bible says so." Now their faith has been vindicated, for with the advent of television and its accessories this passage is easily explained.

[78] *The Christian View of Science and Scripture, P. 29.*

The vast devastation described in The Revelation also seemed exaggerated only a century ago, but the invention of the atom, hydrogen and nitrogen bombs during this last generation has made these predictions easy to accept. The Author of that amazing Book, the Bible, had television and the bomb in mind nineteen hundred years ago when He inspired John to write The Revelation. Why, then, do Ramm and other neo-evangelicals bow so low before science and give the Bible a secondary place? Referring to what he calls the "battle" between "the Bible and Science," Ramm says: "All the *practical* and *theoretical* success of science added weight to the arguments of Christianity's critics." Then, listing scientific inventions from the steam engine to some of our modern medical marvels, he asks: "What could theologians offer as a parallel to this?"[79]

We do not mean to imply that Ramm questions that true Christian theologians actually had more to offer than did the scientists. We object rather to his downgrading Christianity in comparison with science. He should have pointed out the utter impotence of science where the most vital matters are concerned.

What can science offer to the soul troubled by sin? Years ago a young lad aroused his parents' concern because he was convicted of his lost, sinful condition before God. As he kept going to evangelistic meetings, his father said: "This is going too far. Before we know it he will be a religious fanatic." So they took the lad to a psychiatrist. After considerable consultation the psychiatrist prescribed music lessons to take his mind off himself! Imagine prescribing music lessons for a troubled soul! All the "insights of psychological research," had left the psychiatrist without an answer to man's most urgent question: *"What must I do to be saved?"*

But this is only the beginning, for science is impotent to supply *any* of man's *real* needs. Science may boast how much joy the vacuum cleaner, the electric washer, the dryer and the automobile have brought to the human race, but these material things do not really bring *joy* or satisfy man's deepest longings. Science may beast of the assurance and peace of mind which insurance companies have brought men through their knowledge of mathematics, but it has again and again been demonstrated that there is no real assurance or peace of mind apart from faith in Christ. Science may boast of the medical marvels which have done so much to overcome heart disease, polio and tuberculosis, but the death rate still remains "one apiece" and man's greatest need is still the salvation of his soul, for:

"... It is appointed unto men once to die, but after this the judgment" (Heb. 10:27).

But the Bible does offer salvation, joy and assurance, as a more complete quotation of the above passage indicates.

"And as it is appointed unto men once to die, but after this the Judgment;

[79] *Ibid.,* Pp. 19, 20.

"So Christ was once offered to bear the sins of many; and unto them that look for Him shall He appear the second time without [Lit., apart from] sin unto salvation,"

As we look at the condition of the world about us we seriously question that all man's scientific inventions together have actually made him any better off, but we do not understand why I Cor. 1:20,21 did not come to Dr. Ramm's mind when he asked with regard to the "success" of "Christianity's critics": "What could theologians offer as a parallel to this?" We here quote this passage, which *he* should have quoted:

“Where is the wise? Where is the scribe? Where is the disputer of this world? Hath not God made foolish the wisdom of this world?

"For after that in the wisdom of God, the world by wisdom knew not [did not get to know] God, it pleased God by the [apparent] foolishness of [the] preaching[80] to save them that believe."

FAILURE AND SUCCESS

When Ramm speaks of "the success of the critic and the defeat of the evangelical,”[81] we wonder what, in his judgment, constitutes success. Are unbelievers successful merely because they are in the majority? Surely their "success" in leading others away from God and salvation is not to be envied by any child of God. Or would he pronounce us successful if we could change the course of "this present evil age"? If so he betrays a woeful ignorance of what God is doing during this present dispensation of grace.

With regard to the fundamentalists "losing the battle of the Bible and science...," Ramm says: "The detrimental influence of this on Christianity is beyond any possible calculation.”[82]

But Christians do not win over their scientific opponents merely by becoming more proficient in science, much less by conceding that scientists are probably correct in conclusions which contradict the Bible.

A young scientist stated to me years ago that he *could not* accept the Bible as the Word of God because it contained too many scientific inaccuracies, hence he could not place his faith in Christ as his Savior. We discussed a few of these "inaccuracies," but it was not long before we had gotten into another realm--that of *spiritual truth* regarding sin and salvation, the justice and love of God and the redeeming work of Christ. The young man received Christ as his Savior and in later years often recalled with amusement: "I had a hundred questions and criticisms,

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[80] The definite article appears in the original. The apostle refers to "the preaching of the cross.” See Ver. 18.
[81] *Op.cit*., P. 21.
[82] *Ibid*., Pp. 23, 24.

but once I was saved they all seemed to evaporate. Many of them I could not even recall!"

And this has happened with seasoned scientists too, for many a leading scientist has borne witness to the fact that he was saved *not* because all his scientific objections were answered but because someone confronted him with *spiritual truth* as found in the Word of God.

THE CHURCH AND LOST SOULS

Ramm, like other neo-evangelicals, seems to conclude that many people are lost because they believe that the Bible is scientifically untrustworthy. He certainly believes they are lost to the Church for this reason. He contends that "numerous intelligent and gifted young men... could have served the Church with distinction" but "live outside the Church in the belief that the Holy Scripture is scientifically untrustworthy."[83]

Here he ignores the practice and power of the Holy Spirit in using *His Word* to convict and save the unbeliever, be he scientist or street sweeper.

"Is not My Word like as a fire? saith the Lord; and like a hammer that breaketh the rock in pieces?" (Jer. 23:29),

"For the Word of God is quick [living], and powerful, and sharper than any two-edged sword... and is a discerner of the thoughts and intents of the heart" (Heb. 4:12).

Actually Ramm seems to be more concerned about the stance of the professing Church than about the salvation of souls. This appears in his statement that "Thousands of splendid trained, capable men now lost to secularism, could have provided the Church with an imposing array of scholars in every department of learning ...."[84]

In reply we ask: "Could have, if what?" If these "splendid trained, capable men" were merely convinced that the Bible is scientifically accurate, would this save their souls? And apart from the salvation of their souls how would the Church be benefited by "an imposing array" of such scholars?

WHY IS SCIENCE ANTAGONISTIC?

But Ramm goes even farther when he declares that "in view of the present antagonism of science to evangelical Christianity, the situation will continue and perhaps even grow worse if no reconciliation takes place."[85]

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[83] *Ibid*., P. 24.
[84] *Ibid.,* P. 24.
[85] *Ibid.,* P. 26.

But why is "science" antagonistic toward evangelical Christianity? Is it because Christian leadership does not accept all the latest findings of science? We doubt it. We believe rather that scientists lack confidence in conservative leaders because these leaders are so evidently confused and so hopelessly divided as to God's message for the world today and His program for the Church today, and they are confused and divided because, closing their ears to Paul's inspired declaration: *"I speak to you Gentiles .. I am the apostle of the Gentiles"* (Rom. 11:13), they fail to "rightly divide," rightly understand and rightly teach "the Word of truth." Quite apart from "the findings of science," if a teacher of the Word confuses the kingdom of heaven with the Body of Christ, law with grace and prophecy with the "mystery" revealed through Paul, he is preaching a confused, inconsistent, contradictory message, and intelligent men, whether scientists or not, cannot be expected to accept propositions that do not make sense. But there is another reason why most scientists oppose Christianity.

To Ramm it is appalling that there has not been a reconciliation between science and evangelical Christianity even though he admits that the great majority of scientists are unregenerate men. He even expresses the hope that "something very revolutionary [may] develop in science to reinstate the Bible before the scientists of the world ...."[86]

Need God, then, be reinstated in the graces of unregenerate men? Surely there is overwhelming and ever-increasing proof that the Bible is in agreement with true science, but even casual observation confirms the testimony of Scripture that the unregenerate heart is too blinded to accept even the most conclusive of Christian evidences.

"... the natural man receiveth not the things of the Spirit of God; for they are foolishness unto him; neither can he know [understand] them, for they are spiritually discerned" (I Cor. 2:14).

"... the god of this world [age] hath blinded the minds of them that believe not..." (II Cor 4:4).

Ramm declares that "hyperorthodoxy assumed that man is in open rebellion against God and will use science as well as anything else to oppose Christianity."[87]

Does one have to be hyperorthodox to hold this view or is Ramm leaving Bible orthodoxy behind? Perhaps he and those who, with him, question this truth about man's enmity against God should thoughtfully and prayerfully re-study Rom. 5:10 and Rom. 8:7 and Col. 1:21. If unregenerate men are at enmity against God is it not reasonable to assume that "they will," consciously or subconsciously, "use science as well as anything else to oppose Christianity"? And to *deny* that they *are* at enmity is also to deny the whole Bible doctrine of reconciliation. This statement by Ramm is difficult to understand since he himself declares:

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[86] *Ibid.,* P. 25.
[87] *Ibid.,* P. 27.

"If we were to go from office to office in our modern universities we would discover that considerably more than ninety per cent of the faculty are either completely naturalistic or materialistic in creed, or very nominally religious."[88]

Ramm's exaltation of science, then, and his depreciation of the Word of God, are serious matters, especially in view of the rising tide of infidelity and godlessness which is presently sweeping over western civilization.

What was it that plunged great nations and races into the darkness of pagan idolatry in ancient times? Was it their primitive condition, their lack of scientific knowledge? Far from it, for there is much evidence of the high quality of intelligence which the earliest generations of mankind possessed, and the signs of the Zodiac, the ancient pyramids (particularly one amazing Pyramid at Gizeh) and mummies of the Egyptian dead, all endure to this day to bear witness to the fact that the ancients knew secrets about engineering and chemistry and perhaps also about astronomy, that we do not know, and have not been able to re-discover *even though we possess the products* of this ancient scientific knowledge!

It was as the ancients became wholly preoccupied with science rather than with God that idolatry *resulted.* The opening chapter of Romans brings this out, especially in Verse 25, where we read that they *"worshipped and served the creation more than the Creator* .... " This was what led them on the downward path to idolatry.

"... and their foolish heart was darkened.

"Professing themselves to be wise, they became fools,

"And changed the glory of the uncorruptible God into an image made like unto
"man
"and... birds
"and fourfooted beasts
"and creeping things" (Vers. 21-23).

But Ramm surely sets up a straw dummy when he argues: "It is not intellectually consistent to condemn science as satanic while having teeth repaired by scientific technicians," etc.[89] It was not very "intellectual" of him to slip this one in, for what fundamentalist condemns *science* as satanic?

THE GREAT NEED TODAY

Perhaps Dr. Ramm is correct in saying that "sobering considerations over atomic power have re-awakened some scientists to the important role of religion in civilization."[90]

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[88] *Ibid.,* P 17.
[89] *Ibid.,* P. 29.
[90] *Ibid.,* P. 26.

If so--and man *is* religious by nature---there is all the more reason to reach these scientists with the Pauline "gospel of the grace of God," the consistency and power of which never cease to amaze those who have come to understand it as distinct from "the gospel of the kingdom."

It is not any Bible-science battle, but a *moral* and *spiritual* battle which fundamentalism has lost and the "detrimental influence" of which is "beyond any possible calculation."

As a natural consequence of the dispensational revival mentioned earlier, God in grace gave His people further light on the Scriptures which, if accepted, would have united true believers as never before and would have given such point and power to their proclamation of the gospel that the true Church of fundamental Bible believers would have been a spiritual power to be reckoned with in the world.

We refer again to the recovery of that mighty message which Paul by divine inspiration calls: *"my gospel, and the preaching of Jesus Christ according to the revelation of the mystery"* (Rom. 16:25). Many thousands of fundamentalists did indeed come to see this glorious message and to rejoice in it. But according to this truth of Scripture water baptism, like circumcision and animal sacrifices, has been done away, since by "ONE BAPTISM" all true believers are baptized into "ONE BODY" (I Cor. 12:13; Eph. 4:4,5). Most fundamentalist leaders would have none of this! Their background, their denominational standing, their positions, their salaries were all involved and the cost had to be considered, for it is as costly today to repudiate the rite of water baptism as it was in Paul's day to repudiate the rite of circumcision. Thus most fundamentalist leaders closed their minds and hearts to the God-given light and went spiritually backward, confusing "the gospel of the kingdom" with "the gospel of the grace of God," the "kingdom of heaven" with the "Body of Christ" and baptism with water unto the remission of sins with our baptism into Christ and His Body by grace through "the operation of God."

Whatever other considerations may be involved, the opponents of "the preaching of Jesus Christ according to the revelation of the mystery" are most upset over the fact that according to this message water baptism has no place in the present dispensation of grace. But it is not without significance that they themselves are so confused and divided on this subject that in more than thirty-five years they have not been able to produce even so much as a one hundred page book *answering* these teachings by the Scriptures. Rather they have misrepresented those who have taught these truth and have warned their followers against them. [91]

It is this blind resistance against the distinctive character of Paul's apostleship and the blessed truths made known in his God-given revelation, that has caused the present stagnation in fundamentalism and has brought about the rise of neo-evangelicalism.

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[91] See the writer's book, *The Controversy.*

"When Israel wandered from God, in days of old, it was not merely because she rebelled against the Word of God in general, but because she rebelled against the Word of God *through Moses* in particular, and in the revival under Ezra, for example, the people were not called upon to follow programs in force in former dispensations, but were exhorted to return in obedience to *the law of Moses.* Did this exalt Moses above God? In no wise, for Moses' authority was not inherent; it was *delegated* to him by God.

"Just so the present deplorable condition of the Church is due, not merely to rebellion against the Word of God in general, but to rebellion against the Word of God *through Paul* in particular. Nor does God now call upon us to go back to programs in force in former dispensations, but to follow, in obedience, the program of grace, for as surely as *the dispensation of the law* was committed to Moses, so surely was *the dispensation of the grace of God* later committed to Paul, as he says in Eph. 3: 1-3:

"'For this cause I Paul, the prisoner of Jesus Christ for you Gentiles,

"'If ye have heard of THE DISPENSATION OF THE GRACE OF GOD which is given me to you-ward;

"'How that by revelation He made known unto me the mystery ...'"[92]

In dealing with neo-evangelicalism and science we might have included statements by Nash, Henry, Carnell and other neo-evangelicals, but we have concentrated on Bernard Ramm because his book, *The Christian View of Science and Scripture,* contains, it seems to us, a rather comprehensive and representative presentation of neo-evangelical thought on this subject.

We trust that what we have here pointed out has at least helped our readers to see how wrong it is to place *anything* on the same level with the Word of God, as many of our neo-evangelical friends do in speaking of God's *"two* revelations" and in using similar phraseology with regard to creation and the Bible.

Dr. Ramm goes so far as to say: "If the Author of Nature and of Scripture are the same God, then the two books of God must eventually recite the same story. [93] It is clear from the context that he means that nature and the Bible recite *consistent* stories, for they surely do *not* recite the *same* story.

Nature does indeed "declare the *glory of* God" and "show His *handiwork"* (Psa. 19:1). And nature demonstrates "His eternal *power and Godhead"* (Rom. 1:20). But this knowledge cannot save from sin. The plan of salvation: the message of reconciliation, forgiveness, justification and glorification of sinners by grace through faith--this and all the peace, joy and blessing that accompany it, are to be found *in God's Word alone,* now given to us in *the Bible,* that precious Book which has

[92] The above passage is taken from the writer's book, *Moses* and Paul, *The Dispensers of' Law and Grace.*
[93] *Op. Cit.,* P 32.

brought eternal life and blessing to so many millions. Neo-evangelicals should return to the fundamentalist position and place more emphasis upon this important distinction.

What concerns us most is that Ramm claims to be a conservative, theologically, and he does evidently believe that the Bible is basically the Word of God. But this very fact may induce some sincere Bible believers to follow him in cringing before science and in questioning the divine inerrancy and infallibility of that blessed Book.

Again we say: If our neo-evangelical friends wish *us* to consider them conservatives they should not give away so much that is vital to true Christianity.

Chapter VI

THE NEW EVANGELICALISM AND SOCIAL RESPONSIBILITY

MODERNISM, FUNDAMENTALISM AND THE SOCIAL GOSPEL

In the early nineteen hundreds, when a "new scholarship" and a "new science" were challenging the Bible, "modernist" clergymen, with both their collars and their theology turned backward, were capturing public attention by proclaiming from the pulpit that "all men are brothers as the children of one God," and that by all working together we could make the world a wonderful place to live in.

The steady approach of World War I, however, posed a problem. All men were not acting like brothers, and the fundamentalists were pointing to the Scriptures to explain why.

Soon the war broke out in all its fury and it was not long before the U.S.A. became involved and millions of her sons were sent to Europe to fight. Nothing daunted, however, the modernists, with more optimism than faith in God's Word, declared that this would be "the last war," "a war to end wars," "a war to make the world safe for democracy."

The results of the war certainly did not justify the modernists' optimism and, annoyed by the fundamentalists' "I told you sos," they now began to place greater emphasis on their "social gospel." The Church, by her teachings, her example and her participation in the affairs of the world, must transform society and so bring in the kingdom of Christ. Phrases like "character building," "community uplift," and "the betterment of society" were liberally sprinkled through all good modernist literature.

The social gospel, however, proved completely ineffective. Pastor J. C. O'Hair once chided the modernists with the words: "If they are going to bring the world into the kingdom of Christ they are going to have to back it in, for it is not headed that way!"

It was at this time, and in the years directly following, that the fundamentalists won significant spiritual victories. Bible conferences drew great throngs to study the Word of God, Bible institutes were established all over the country and missionaries were sent to foreign lands in unprecedented numbers.

As we have pointed out, it was during this era that God used the *Scofield Reference Bible,* perhaps more than any other one instrument, to open the eyes of untold thousands to the importance of "rightly dividing the Word of Truth," and great men of God supplied eager Bible students with helpful commentaries for their libraries.

Finally, with the emergence of radio, Bible-believing fundamentalism received its greatest impetus. Radio, it is true, generally gave free weekly time spots to the modernists, represented by their local church councils or by the *Federal* (now *National) Council of Churches,* but it was the fundamentalists who paid the price to sponsor the great coast-to-coast broadcasts which won still greater numbers to personal faith in Christ and Bible-centered Christianity.

A FUNDAMENTALIST SETBACK

As the century drew on, however, the fundamentalists began to flounder.

God, in His grace, had been giving further light on His Word. The great distinctive truths of Paul's apostleship and message were being rapidly recovered. We were emerging ever farther, it seemed, from the dark ages as the Blessed Book was becoming more intelligible--and more blessed--to increasing thousands of believers. A significant proportion of the fundamentalists were diligently studying the Word of God, desiring to be *"filled with the knowledge of His will, in all wisdom and spiritual understanding,"* that they might be *"fruitful in every good work"* (Col. 1:9,10).

The unifying character of the Pauline revelation offered high hope that the true Church might at last be united to present a stronger-than-ever witness to the world in what already appeared to be the closing days of the dispensation of grace.

As we have said, however, many of our fundamentalist leaders closed their eyes to the new light. They swore by the "Scofield Bible," as it were, and branded as heresy any deviation from its "notes" or any attempt to build upon the foundation which Scofield had laid.

It is not ours to judge as to what part positions, salaries, popularity, etc., had in this attitude, but it is certain that this resistance to truth so clearly revealed and so wholly unanswered by its critics, contributed largely to the spiritual decline which in turn resulted in the rise of the "new evangelicalism" which is now troubling almost every fundamentalist organization in the country.

God will not give further light on His Word while our eyes are closed. He speaks only when faith listens. We believe, therefore, that a true spiritual revival will take place among Bible-believing Christians only when they open their hearts to the light He has so graciously given. We fundamentalists must recognize and acknowledge not only the legitimacy of some of the neo-evangelical complaints against us, but *the root cause* of our spiritual decline: the exaltation of man-made creeds above the written Word of God, and resistance to the recovery of Bible truths which have exposed some of our beliefs and practices as invalid.

The Bible must again be given its rightful place among us, not merely in lip service, but as the Word of God indeed, to be studied and rightly divided, to be believed and obeyed, and to be *used* daily in witnessing to others.

A NEO-EVANGELICAL COMPLAINT

We have already enumerated some of the complaints lodged against the fundamentalists by the neo-evangelicals. One of the foremost of these is fundamentalism's lack of social responsibility and social concern.

Before we deal with this subject from the Scriptures, let us see what the neo-evangelicals have to say about it.

In an article in *Christian Life* mentioned earlier it was stated that a changing evangelical theology was giving more definite recognition to social responsibility.[94]

In the same issue Dr. Vernon Grounds, now president of *Conservative Baptist Seminary* in Denver, wrote: *"We* must... make evangelicalism more relevant to the political and sociological realities of our times."

Just what the neo-evangelicals mean by this is often difficult to determine, since so many of their statements on the subject contain only broad generalizations. To answer them by the Scriptures, however, we must first understand their views as clearly as possible.

Do they mean that we should be concerned about the teeming millions of the unsaved about us; that we are responsible to carry the gospel of the grace of God to them? We fundamentalists also believe this. Do they mean that we should minister to the sick and help the poor and unfortunate as a means of winning them to Christ? We too believe this, and without attempting to compare our philanthropic and missionary efforts at home and abroad with those of the liberal camp, or even the neo-evangelical camp, we plead guilty to the charge that we have failed to show enough concern for the masses or to assume our full responsibility in this regard.

But this is not exactly what the neo-evangelicals mean by social responsibility and social concern. Certainly it is not *all* they mean. The writings of their leading spokesmen have made it clear that they rather come perilously close to championing the "social gospel" by which the modernists of the early nineteen hundreds hoped to transform the world.

In 1958 Dr. Harold J. Ockenga wrote: "[The New Evangelical] breaks with the fundamentalist on the fact that he believes that the Biblical teaching, the Bible doctrine and ethics, must apply to the social scene, that there must be an application of this to society, as much as there is . . . to the individual man."[95]

Mark well, Dr. Ockenga does not refer here to reaching the masses with the gospel, but to the application of "Bible doctrine and ethics" to "the social scene" as well as "to the individual man."

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[94] "Is Evangelical Theology Changing?" *Christian Life*, March, 1956.
[95] *Park Street Spire*, Feb., 1958. as quoted by Nash in *The New Evangelicalism*, P. 14.

Another statement by Dr. 0ckenga throws further light on his meaning. "Fundamentalism," he says, "has demonstrated little power to crack the social situation challenging the Church today."[96]

But Ronald Nash goes farther than Ockenga when he says: "[Fundamentalists] were often accused of avoiding social problems, by asserting that salvation alone was the answer. While the new birth is a powerful force for the good of society, Christians do need more than it in solving the varied and complex social issues of the day.[97]

Nash says further: "As long as fifteen years ago, evangelicals warned that fundamentalism was failing to provide answers to the complex social and ethical problems facing the world."[98]

Dr. Carl F. H. Henry, writing only recently on "the demand for social change," said: "In the area of social concern, evangelicals need to extend themselves in energetic devotion to social justice to match their unrivaled zeal for proclamation of the Gospel," and he states in the same article: "The United Nations may not be the world's ultimate hope for peace, but it is nonetheless a useful instrument ...."[99]

Other declarations by Henry follow:

"Evangelicals insist that social justice is a divine requirement for the whole human race, not for the Church alone."[100]

"By maintaining the connection between social reform and the law of love, evangelicals face the organized evils of society with the power of sanctified compassion ...."[101]

"The new order is therefore not simply a distant dream; it exists already in an anticipative way in the regenerate fellowship of the Church ...."[102]

Note carefully the phrases "social action," "social justice," "social reform" and "new order." This is the phraseology used by modernists who proclaimed the "social gospel" years ago, and by the communists until this day.

It is vain to argue, as some do, that all neo-evangelicals do not hold the above views. Dr. Harold Ockenga is well known as "the father of neo-evangelicalism." Ronald Nash is the author of *The New Evangelicalism,* a book which Dr. Ockenga has recommended without qualification, and Dr. Henry, as editor of *Christianity Today,* is doubtless the leading spokesman for the new evangelicalism. These men

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[96] *Fuller Theological Seminary Bulletin,* Oct.- Dec., 1954.
[97] *The New Evangelicalism,* P. 24.
[98] *Ibid.,* P. 30.
[99] *Decision,* Oct., 1966, P. 3.
[100] "Perspective for Social Action," *Christianity Today,* Feb. 2, 1959.
[101] *Ibid.*
[102] *Ibid.*

do hold these views and, along with other neo-evangelicals, are winning thousands of unwary and untaught believers to their cause.

We do not suggest that these men deny the fundamentals of the faith, but they are certainly weak in their stand for the fundamentals, advocating fellowship and cooperation with unbelieving apostates and, like the liberals, pinks and communist sympathizers, they are endeavoring to bring in a new social order with "justice for all."

In the light of Carl Henry's words, quoted above, it is not too surprising that the recent *World Congress on Evangelism,* neo-evangelicalism's extravaganza, excluded from its number Dr. Richard Wurmbrand who, for his stand for Christ, was subjected to terrible tortures during his fourteen years as a prisoner of the communists in Rumania. He was not welcome, for he was a living symbol of communism's bitter enmity against Christianity and this might antagonize Soviet Russia. Indeed, those in charge of the Congress, in order to have representatives present from the iron curtain countries, actually agreed to communist demands that nothing be said by the Congress speakers about communism! Should any reader doubt this, we quote from a letter written to Dr. Wurmbrand by Mr. Zoefi, associate director for arrangements for the *World Congress on Evangelism.* Mr. Zoefi wrote, explaining why Dr. Wurmbrand's invitation to the Congress had been cancelled:

"In many cases we have had to promise that the Congress would touch only on matters of the Church and Religion and not on anything that would be considered political .... Many of the brethren from the Eastern countries will be obtaining visas only because they have assured their governments that this Congress will not deal with anything that borders on political matters such as Communism and so forth."[103]

Dr. Wurmbrand rightly inquires: *"...* may I ask what we win by this concession...?" and adds: "Now as far as Rumania, Russia, Hungary, China, Albania and a few other countries are concerned, I can assure you that either nobody will come or, if anybody comes, you can put your hand in the fire that he is a man of the Secret Police.

"I come from behind the Iron Curtain and it is unimaginable that from these countries anybody should be able to attend such a Congress if he is not an informer of the Secret Police."[104]

Thus, not only did the neo-evangelicals join with apostates to "win souls for Christ," but, turning their backs on today's martyr Church, the thousands who are suffering and dying for Christ in communist countries, they assured iron curtain governments that they would keep quiet about atheistic communism.

For this reason alone this writer would not wish to be numbered with the neo-evangelicals, and we wonder that any Bible-believing Christian, much less any

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[103] *Christian Beacon,* Dec. 8, 1966, P. 8.
[104] *Ibid.*

member of the so-called "grace movement," would champion neo-evangelicalism as opposed to fundamentalism. When so-called conservatives hold hands with apostates and cooperate with communism to "get the great commission under way," it is high time that we make it clear that we will have nothing whatever to do with this unholy alliance.

WHAT THE BIBLE SAYS ABOUT "SOCIETY"

It would be difficult, probably, to find a closer Bible synonym to our English word *society* than the Greek *kosmos,* which means "arrangement" and most often refers to the world system, or world order, in which we live. This word, almost without exception, is rendered "world" in the *Authorized Version* of the Bible.

As we consider what the Bible says about our world system, one thing stands out clearly: It is always viewed as *against* God and is rejected and condemned by Him.

Our Lord, while on earth, twice designated Satan as *"the prince of this world"* (John 14:30; 16:11) and declared to Pilate that HIS kingdom was *"not of this world"* (John 18:36).

James exhorts his readers to keep themselves *"unspotted from the world"* and warns that *"whosoever will be a friend of the world is the enemy of God"* (James 1:27; 4:4).

Peter rejoices that believers have *"escaped the corruption that is in the world"* and *"the pollutions of the world, through the knowledge of the Lord and Savior Jesus Christ"* (II Pet. 1:4; 2:20).

John declares: *"The world knoweth us not, because it knew Him not"* and *"Marvel not, my brethren, if the world hate you"* (I John 3:1,13). Indeed, he goes so far as to say: *"We are of God, and the whole world lieth in [the lap of] wickedness* [Gr., *"the wicked one"]"* (I John 5:19).

Paul bears the same witness as to the nature of the world, for this is no dispensational matter. By the Christ of the cross, he says, *"the world is crucified unto me"--and* the feeling is mutual ! -- *"and I unto the world"* (Gal. 6:14). How could he become enthused about a system that had no place for the Christ of Calvary? And they could not become enthused about *him* since all he kept boasting about was the cross!

Those who walk according to *"the course of this world,"* declares the apostle, are actually following Satan, *"the spirit that now worketh in the children of disobedience"* (Eph. 2:2). And conversely he says:

"Now we have received, not the spirit of the world, but the spirit which is of God; that we might know the things that are freely given to us of God" (I Cor. 2:12).

This is God's appraisal of society, and particularly *our* society in "this present evil age" (Gal. 1:4).

Now with this in view are we to "provide answers to the complex social and ethical problems facing the world"? Are we to take part in "solving the varied and complex social issues of the day"? And are we to be censured if we "demonstrate little power to crack the social situation challenging the Church today"? Is it ours to bring about, or help to bring about, "social justice," "social reform" and a "new order"?

The neo-evangelicals answer at least a qualified *"Yes."* Together with the liberals they have convinced many sincere believers that the Church is here, among other things, to engage in reform movements, to identify themselves with social endeavors, to join hands with men of the world in promoting social justice, to make the world a better place to live in.

But on the basis of the above Scriptures, plus a whole volume of other Scripture passages on this subject, we answer *"NO!"*

The Church is not here to improve the world. She is here to testify that the world cannot be made acceptable to God, indeed, that as the age progresses the world will grow "worse and worse," morally and spiritually, until Christ returns from heaven to put down the rebellion and set up His reign.

The present futile attempts of world leaders to establish lasting peace are but another confirmation of the predictions of Scripture that this age of Christ's rejection would be marked by "wan and rumors of wars," and that lasting peace will not be established until the "Prince of Peace" returns to take the throne (Isa. 2:4; 11:1-5; Jer. 23:5; Zech. 14:1-4; Matt. 24:3-7,27; Acts 1:9-11; Rev. 1:7).

The Church is not here to promote world betterment, but to testify that God will judge it as it grows more and more materialistic, more given over to self-gratification and self-exaltation.

Dr. Henry, as we have seen above, declares that evangelicals need to extend themselves in energetic devotion to social justice to match their zeal for the proclamation of the gospel.

But even though "the gospel of the kingdom," which our Lord proclaimed while on earth, was basically a new way of life, He did not make an issue of social justice or lead crusades for social reform. He did not proclaim the "rights" of the poor. Rather He declared that He was anointed of God "to *preach the gospel* to the poor" (Luke 4:18). When a man asked Him merely to "speak" to his brother about dividing an inheritance with him, our Lord replied: "Man, who made Me a judge or a divider over you?" And then He warned all of His hearers to *"beware of covetousness"* (Luke 12:14,15).

The Apostle Paul lived in days of great injustice, including slavery, yet he did not go about proclaiming human rights or championing social reform. Rather he exhorted Christian slaves to be faithful and devoted slaves for Christ's sake.

The apostle did make it clear that *before God* all men are equal; that God is no respecter of persons. He also taught that *in Christ* all believers are one, but it is a sad perversion of this glorious truth to teach that just because *we* are one in Christ we should recognize no distinctions between men in human relations, or preach the *social* equality of all, and this is certainly what the official statement of the *World Congress on Evangelism* seems to say.[105] The relation of evangelism to social concern," says a special report on the Berlin *Congress*, "was a recurring theme.... "A number of delegates communicated their convictions to Congress Chairman Carl Henry, and "from this grew the 1,000-word declaration that was issued at the close of the Congress."[106] Thus the official declaration of the World Congress on *Evangelism* grew out of the convictions of some regarding "social concern," i.e., human relations and social equality. This is why the statement has as much or more to say about race relations as it does about the gospel.

But no amount of preaching will improve the old Adamic nature, which lies at the root of all social injustice and wrong. Thus our Lord came to provide a payment for sin and to create a new humanity.

"Therefore if any man be in Christ, 'he is a new creature [Lit., there is a new creation] ..." (II Cor. 5:17).

The Church has always exerted its greatest influence in the world in an indirect way, by keeping close to Christ, separate from the world, and so keeping spiritually strong.

The Church is to testify to the world in such a way that none will be deceived or lulled to sleep as to God's judgment upon sin. It is here to warn men in no uncertain terms that this world-system (society) is condemned by God and doomed to destruction; that its best systems of civilization will be swept away at the coming of the Lord, and that the individual's only hope of salvation is in Christ.

The Church is here to save men *out of* this world system and *from* "this present evil age" (Gal. 1:4). Our Lord prayed for His disciples:

"They am not of the world, even as I am not of the world.

"Sanctify them [Lit., "set them apart"] through Thy truth; Thy Word is truth" (John 17:16,17).

This is the way to make our ministry "more relevant to the political and sociological realities of our times."

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[105] *Christianity Today,* Nov. 25, 1966, P. 24. Cf. this writer's booklet on "God and Human Relations."
[106] *Ibid.,* P. 34.

The Church is not here to save the wreck which man has made of society, but to save perishing souls from the wreck, which is already doomed to destruction. The neo-evangelicals, however, have fallen for the liberals' line that we are supposed somehow to save, or help save, the wreck.

The teaching that the Church is here to bring in social justice or moral and political reform can produce a devastating reaction. It can act as a boomerang, for if we are God's instrument to improve the world, and under our ministry conditions become worse rather than better, may not the world justly turn on us to destroy us?

Here it is relevant to point out that the neo-evangelicals have had nearly two decades, with the most elaborate organization, the most abundant finances and the greatest outreach of all time, to demonstrate *their* power to "crack the social situation challenging the Church," and to "solve the varied and complex social issues of the day," but without avail, for today society is in far worse condition than before the neo-evangelicals started doing things in a big way.

CONFUSED INTELLECTUALS

Despite all their emphasis on intellectualism, the neo-evangelicals appear to be making no significant contributions toward a clearer understanding of the Word of God. This could hardly be otherwise in view of the fact that they have reduced their doctrinal standards to a bare minimum so as to include as many shades of belief as possible in their fellowship. Their slogan is: "Let's forget our differences and get together on what we do believe." Thus they must constantly talk in generalities. They cannot be too specific on the fundamental Bible doctrines and still maintain their broad base of fellowship.

Worst of all, they are pathetically confused as to what God is doing in this present dispensation of grace, a subject they ought to understand clearly if they are to be "workers together with God" in winning the lost to Christ.

Neo-evangelicals, like many sincere fundamentalists, believe that they should be carrying out the so-called "great commission," the commission which our Lord gave to His eleven (later twelve) apostle while on earth. But again, while they often refer to this commission in a general way they shy away from discussing the details. The statement of the *World Congress on Evangelism* calls this commission "the supreme mission of the Church" and says: "We implore the world Church to obey the divine commission .... " Indeed, the Congress has proclaimed as its goal, "nothing short of the evangelization of the human race [under this commission] in this generation."[107] But if the neo-evangelicals endeavored to carry this commission out *in detail* they would only add to the confusion prevailing among fundamentalists who consider it their "marching orders."

We will go into this subject at greater length when we deal with neo-evangelicalism and evangelism, but it should be noted here that this

[107] *Ibid.*

misunderstanding of the Scriptures accounts largely for neo-evangelical views on social responsibility.

In Old Testament times Israel was God's chosen nation, with a theocratic government. At that time there was a legitimate place for calls to social justice and political reform. When our Lord was on earth He, with His apostles, proclaimed "the gospel of the kingdom," and a study of the Sermon on the Mount will reveal that this good news had to do with a way of life on earth with Christ as King.

As we know, however, the King and His kingdom were rejected and the glorious reign of Christ is now held in abeyance. It was after the message of the twelve had failed to bring Israel to Messiah's feet that God ushered in a new dispensation by raising up *another* apostle, *Paul.* During this "dispensation of the grace of God" (See Eph. 3:1-3) He is not dealing with nations but with individuals, reconciling believing Jews and Gentiles to Himself in one body by the cross.

"For God hath concluded, them all in unbelief, that He might have mercy upon all" (Rom. 11:32).

"And that He might reconcile both unto God in one body by the cross, having slain the enmity thereby" (Eph. 2:16).

This "one Body" enjoys a heavenly position and heavenly blessings in Christ (Eph. 1:3; 2:4-6). Its members are therefore viewed in Scripture as *ambassadors* of reconciliation *in a foreign land*--yea on enemy territory (II Cor. 5:20).[108] Nowhere in the epistles of Paul, our apostle, are we instructed to crusade for social justice, civil rights or political reform. Rather, as ambassadors, we are to offer reconciliation to "enemy aliens," proclaiming "the gospel of the grace of God" in "the preaching of the cross," the good news of the glorious, all-sufficient, finished work of Christ at Calvary.

How sad, then, to read in the writings of "the father of neo-evangelicalism" that "only one gospel is taught by all the writers of the New Testament, including Paul."[109] How sad to hear Dr. Henry, neo-evangelicalism's chief champion, say that "evangelicals need to extend themselves in energetic devotion to social justice to match their unrivaled zeal for proclamation of the Gospel" and to hear him add that "the United Nations... is a useful instrument" for peace.[110]

How can the neo-evangelicals work intelligently in the service of God when they do not even know what He is doing? How can instructed and faithful believers join hands with a system of civilization which God has doomed to judgment and which, at best, gives the rejected Christ only lip service? How can we take part in projects to improve a system which God has foredoomed to failure?

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[108] See the author's booklet: *Ambassadors for Christ.*
[109] "Church With a Global Shadow." *World Vision,* March, 1964.
[110] *Decision,* Oct., 1966, P. 3.

Let the world fight its futile battles over capital and labor, civil rights, social justice, etc. We have a far greater battle to wage against the principalities and powers in the heavenlies, against the god of this age, who would blind the minds of unbelievers and confuse and divide the saints (See II Cor. 4:3,4; Eph. 6:12).

The very word *church,* in our Bibles, comes from the Greek *ekklesia,* which means "called out," i.e., from the world. Thus Dr. I. M. Haldeman once observed: "A Bible-believing Christian and a Bible-rejecting worldling have no more cohesion than iron and clay."

The Church is in the world to be a living protest against the claim of the old nature and a constant witness to the claim of the new. It is to deny that the natural man can *ever* please God (Rom. 8:8) even by being more just, kind and good. To endeavor to please God while rejecting His Son is like sending a gift to one whose beloved son--and your benefactor --you despise.

God, today, is not making an issue of sin. He has concluded all under sin (Gal. 3:22) and has made full provision for salvation. But He does ask: "What will you do about My Son and His payment for your sins?" It is the Church's responsibility, therefore, to let the men of this world know that God cares about their attitude toward His Son.

"For the Father loveth the Son, and hath given all things into His hand.

"He that believeth on the Son hath everlasting life: and he that believeth not the Son shall not see life; but the wrath of God abideth on him" (John 3:35,36).

The Church, then, is not here to improve the world, but to build herself up, by diligent study of the Word and by faithfully presenting Christ to the lost.

The appearance of neo-evangelicalism on the religious scene is raising issues which every sincere believer must sooner or later face, though its subtlety has caught many true saints unaware. But let us remember this: Antichrist will not be atheistic or anti-religious. Far from it. His appeal will be more subtle than that. This is the great peril of the apostasy which neo-evangelicalism regards so lightly that it joins hands with its leaders to "win souls for Christ" and bring about social reform.

Chapter VII

THE NEW EVANGELICALISM AND THE SEPARATED LIFE

TRUE SANCTIFICATION

Most Bible students know that the words "holiness" and "sanctification" in our *Authorized Version* come from Hebrew and Greek roots meaning simply *"to* set apart" or *"to* separate." In Bible *usage,* however, to make holy or to sanctify means "to set apart *as sacred,"* to *consecrate,* to *dedicate.* The following passages are but a few of the many that bear this out:

Gen. 2:3: "And God blessed the seventh day and SANCTIFIED it."

Ex. 3:5: "Put off thy shoes from off thy feet, for the place whereon thou standest is HOLY ground."

Matt. 6:9: "HALLOWED be Thy name."

II Cor. 11:2: "... I have ESPOUSED you to one husband, that I may present you as a chaste virgin to Christ."

In the above passages the Hebrew and Greek words in question are variously rendered "sanctified," "holy," "hallowed" and "espoused," but in each case the meaning is clearly, "set apart as *sacred," "consecrated," "dedicated."*

What rich blessing many careless believers would experience if they realized that both in our salvation and in our walk it is God's purpose to set us apart *as sacred to Himself,* much as the bridegroom can say of his bride: *"She is mine--mine alone!"*

True Scriptural sanctification, or holiness, does not consist in dos and don’ts, nor is it to be confused with sinless perfection. It is rather a consecration to God which in itself will keep us separate from the world and from apostate Christendom.[111]

Does Scriptural sanctification, then, mean that we can be of no spiritual good to the unsaved about us? On the contrary we can bear a more effective witness to them if they see that our hearts are wholly given to Him, not to be seduced no matter what the attraction, just as a husband and wife who are wholly devoted to each other exert a better influence on those about them than would otherwise be possible.

[111] For a fuller consideration of Scriptural sanctification see the author's book, *True Spirituality*.

That God would have His people wholly separated to Himself is clear from hundreds of Scripture passages. We cite but a few:

John 17:17: "Sanctify them through Thy truth: Thy Word is truth."

Eph. 5:25,26: "Husbands love your wives, even as Christ also loved the Church, and gave Himself for it;

"That He might sanctify and cleanse it with the washing of water by the Word."

I Thes. 5:22,23: "Abstain from all appearance [Lit., every form] of evil."

"And the very God of peace sanctify you wholly…."

II Tim. 2:21: "If a man therefore purge himself . . . he shall be a vessel unto honor, sanctified, and meet for the Master's use .... "

With the foregoing in mind let us now see how the new evangelicalism violates God's Word as to sanctification, and has already gone far toward obliterating the line between truth and error, fidelity and apostasy, the Church and the world.

Leading neo-evangelicals have for years criticized, sometimes ridiculed the fundamentalists for their "separatism." Sometimes the fundamentalists deserved the censure, for many of them have indeed insulated themselves from the lost about them, satisfied to merely go to church, sing hymns, and testify *there* how glad they are that *they* are saved.

But the neo-evangelicals, to correct this situation, have disobeyed the clear commands of Scripture as to separation, speaking disparagingly of those who seek to obey these commands.

NEO-EVANGELICALISM AND THE WORLD

By the word "world" we mean, of course, this world system. As the *Scofield Reference Bible* rightly says of the original word, *kosmos: "...* the ethically bad sense of the word refers to the order or arrangement under which Satan has organized the world of unbelieving mankind upon his cosmic principles of force, greed, selfishness, ambition and pleasure ...."[112]

It is this "world" that we referred to in Chapter VI, where we saw from Scripture that Satan is "the prince of this world," that "the whole world lieth in [the lap of] wickedness [Gr., the wicked one] *,"* that believers are "not of the world" and have "escaped the pollutions of the world" through the knowledge of Christ, that believers should not love the world, neither the things of the world, that they should be "crucified to the world" and keep themselves "unspotted from the world."

[112] See note at Rev. 13:8.

But now let us see neo-evangelicalism's attitude toward the world and "the things that are in the world."

In Joe Bayly's *Gospel Blimp,* it is not the separated Christians but "those worldly Griscoms" who win their cigarette-smoking, beer-drinking neighbors to Christ. In his novel it is easy, of course, to picture the separated fundamentalists as below par mentally, inconsistent Scripturally and not willing to become "involved" with the unsaved, while the Griscoms have oh so great a concern for the lost! But *how* do the Griscoms win their neighbors to Christ? By *staying away* from church and going to the shore with them on Sunday, thus demonstrating that they are not "holy Joes"!

If this writer may be permitted a personal word here he can testify that he has never known a more zealous or more effective soul-winner than his own father, Peter Stare, Sr. But when unsaved friends would send word that they were "coming over on Sunday," he would respond in obedience to Heb. 10:25: "Come right over and go to church with us; we always go to church on Sundays." This, we affirm, would have a far greater effect than staying home or "going out" to please them, for gaining the *respect* of the unsaved is one of the prime requisites of effective soul-winning. One does not win the lost to Christ by going along with them in their worldliness so as to get a chance to testify--except in novels of course, and this novel lets "those worldly Griscoms" win the prize as soul-winners.

Clear evidence of neo-evangelicalism's friendship with the world appeared in the Dec. 23, 1957, issue of *Christianity Today,* in an article titled, *"Any Good--From Hollywood?"* Listen to some of the arguments in favor of a closer relationship with this capital of worldliness, as presented by R. C. Halverson, the writer:

"When occasionally Hollywood produces a picture with moral or spiritual thrust, those who should applaud refuse patronage and the result is box office failure." *Those who should applaud!* Applaud what? Applaud our adversary's genius in slipping in a "good" picture now and then to get Christians interested in the movies? Applaud Hollywood for not *always* dishing up a combination of sex and brutality? Applaud some individual "Christians" in Hollywood for being where they don't belong?

Halverson goes on: "One might think God loves the world--except Hollywood .... *"But* his got his worlds mixed up, for John 3:16, where the word is clearly *not* used in "the ethically bad sense," refers to people, while Hollywood represents the world which God does *not* love, for it is undoubtedly the entertainment capital of the U.S.A., if not of the world, and keeps millions everywhere from thinking about their need of salvation.

Therefore we would answer with a resounding *Yes!* when Halverson asks whether we should forsake Hollywood with its "overwhelming potential for good." Rather we should say that Christian believers shouldn't be part of it in the first place. More than that, we declare that it is wishful, unscriptural thinking to suppose that there *is* any "potential for good" in Hollywood as such, or to pray for "the

redemption of Hollywood" and "a spiritual awakening that will capture its talents, in part at least, to evangelize the world."

What nonsense! This article in America's foremost neo-evangelical periodical was published ten years ago. Even before that outstanding neos were trying to capture Hollywood for Christ. Result? Don't look at your TV to see, for sex and violence have taken over as never before, so that decent mothers have to run to shut off shows their children should not see.

To show how far this flirtation with the world has gone we have but to turn to another issue of *Christianity Today,* dated Jan. 21, 1966. Here we find an article titled, *"Jazz Goes To Fifth Avenue Church."*

This article concerns an appearance by "Duke Ellington and his friends" at New York's Fifth Avenue Presbyterian Church for a religious musicale. *Christianity Today* states that some Protestants now see "jazz in worship" as "an evangelistic wedge. Something like the suburban church that recently stuck an evangelistic message in the middle of a rock 'n' roll dance and called it Revival-A-Go-Go." To quote the article further:

"Host pastor Bryant Kirkland said the Ellington concerts were 'an attempt to establish contact with people normally outside the church' and 'churchgoers, who are not ministered to by the usual presentations.'

"Ellington hoped his concerts would help to bring people into the fold.'"

Kirkland said that a small percentage of his congregation opposed Ellington's appearance imposing a "Puritan interpretation" because of his "life in night clubs and dance halls."

To continue: "Kirkland began things with an invocation that included John 8:16. Then he introduced the Duke... as 'one of God's gentlemen and a man of faith.'"

The whole performance was indeed a jazzy one, with pseudo-religious numbers including an item from *My People:* "Make 100 per cent your goal, and make it to save your soul .... Get yourself a little straighter; it pays a million to one later."

This article appeared under *Christianity Today's* "NEWS: Religion and the Arts." But does this neo-evangelical periodical *condemn* this sort of "evangelism"? No, indeed. It goes no farther than to conclude that "the whole bit was more of a maybe than a yes." Indeed a brief note is added regarding *"The Faith of the Duke,"* which states that "he is conservative about the Bible itself" and quotes him as saying: "If I didn't go into it with the right spirit, then those beautiful colored windows in the sanctuary would come crashing down on my head!"

Indeed, in still another accompanying item this periodical says: "Pentecostalists usually take a dim view of modern entertainment, but one preacher, the Rev. D. Le Roy Sanders, has been re-thinking things since actress Betty Hutton and her jazz

star husband joined his church." Her jazz star husband, Peter Candoli, is her fourth husband, by the way, but Sanders says that Candoli has *stayed in the jazz world* and survived! "He really testifies among fellow musicians, keeps his life clean, and loves the Lord." We wonder what he plays with those fellow musicians.

It is sad indeed that the world and the Church have become so intertwined that gospel hymns, sung by night dub performers, are heard from juke boxes in every tavern, while jazz is played in--of all things, a Presbyterian church!

Still another example of this fellowship with the world is found in an article on Christian colleges in *Christianity Today,* Sept. 2, 1966, in which Roland F. Chase of *Young Life* deplores the protectiveness of Christian colleges and pleads for more involvement with the outside world.

Chase complains that "there is too little real integration of Christian students with the world beyond the campus" in "Christian colleges that aim to turn out leaders who will win the world to Christ ...."

We might interject here that if Chase or any Christian college has hopes of winning the world to Christ they had better start studying the Bible all over again. But to continue with Chase's article:

"The answer is that involvement with the outside world must become one of the goals of the Christian school." Thus, Chase says, we can "transform the evangelical college from a mere 'religious' school into a driving force for Christ, for a new community, and for a new world.

"Positive steps must be taken to ventilate Christian campuses with winds from the non-Christian world."

"Chances are," says Chase, "that friendship will be met by friendship, and openness by openness" if we invite to our campuses such groups as "the Peace Corps, National Student Association, and responsible civil rights organizations."

Chase does sound a note of caution. "Ventilating Christian campuses with the winds from the non-Christian world," he says, "must in no way lead to watering down of theological convictions." But how, pray tell, can this be avoided, when "openness" is met with "openness," especially among impressionable young college students? When Christian colleges become thus "involved" (a wonderful neo-evangelical term!) with outside movements, some of which are actually ungodly and subversive, what good to insist, as Chase does: "These colleges need to remain *thoroughly* Christian." It is just because of this friendship with the world that so many Christian colleges are *not* remaining "thoroughly" Christian.

But upon what Scriptures does Mr. Chase base his conclusions? He uses one passage of Scripture: John 17:11-18, in this order:

"... Christ, speaking to His Father about believers, says that although they are not of the world (John 17:16) they are in the world (17:11), that they have been sent into the world (17:18), and that they are not to remove themselves from the world (17:15)."

Here note carefully (1.) the changed order, (2.) what he has omitted, and (3.) what he has misinterpreted.

First, our Lord prayed to His Father in behalf of those who were to remain "in the world" (Vers. 11,13). Why? Listen further: *"I have given them Thy Word; and the world hath hated them, because they are not of the world, even as I am not of the world"* (Ver. 14).

Then, He proceeded: *"I pray not that Thou shouldest take them out of the world, but that Thou shouldest keep them from the evil. They are not of the world, even as I am not of the world. Sanctify them [set them apart] through Thy truth: Thy Word is truth"(Vers.* 15-17). This latter request Chase omits.

It is against *this* background that our Lord continued: *"As Thou hast sent Me into the world, even so have I also sent them into the world"* (Ver. 18). This all sounds very different from Chase's representation of the passage, does it not. Indeed, it is the very *opposite* to an argument for "friendly involvement" with the world. Nor does the passage say that believers are "not to remove themselves from the world." Rather our Lord said, *"I pray not that Thou shouldest take them out of the world"*--this because their testimony would be needed in the world.

The New Scofield Reference Bible rightly joins the old in saying: "Separation is not from *contact* with evil in the world or the church, but from complicity with and conformity to it (John 17:15; II Cor. 6:14-18; Gal. 6:1).[113]

Now, in fact, we ourselves believe in "friendly involvement," but not of the kind promoted by the three articles above referred to. We believe in "friendly involvement" with unsaved individuals, in showing them that we truly love them and want them to know our blessed Lord and Savior as their own, in perhaps inviting the unsaved to our homes for dinner or accepting invitations to theirs. This sort of involvement is encouraged and commended in the Scriptures, but obedience to Scripture on the other hand may compel me to decline to go along with them in something in which they may invite me to take part, lest I dissipate the power of the Spirit in my life. It is the very friendship with the world which Chase advocates that has sapped the Church's spiritual vitality and has left it weak and ill, rather than "a driving force for Christ."

At the risk of boring our readers we refer to still another article which is pertinent here. It is entitled *"Our Worldliness"* and it appeared in the April, 1966, issue of *Action,* another neo-evangelical periodical and the voice of the *National Association of Evangelicals.* This article, while rightly criticizing forms of worldliness

[113] Note at II Cor. 6:17.

in "separated" believers which may go undetected, actually encourages fellowship with the world to win souls to Christ. Let us quote one paragraph:

"A few years ago a student at a prominent evangelical seminary became interested in 'cocktail evangelism.' He made friends with a group of young executives, was invited to their cocktail parties, sipped a martini with them, and won several to Christ. Meanwhile, back at the seminary, this was causing no little stir. At a meeting of the faculty, action was considered to expel the offender from the hallowed halls of theological learning. As discussion progressed, one of the professors tossed his Bible into the middle of the table saying: 'Show me from the Scriptures where he is wrong.' There was an awkward silence while these learned doctors scratched their heads, then a clearing of throats and scraping of chairs as the whole matter was dropped ...."

Amazing! The faculty members of a theological seminary--and they couldn't think of one Scripture that condemned this student's action! With such instructors it is little wonder the student pursued this course to "win souls"! How could anyone half acquainted with the Bible overlook the wise and solemn warning of Prov. 20:1:

"Wine is a mocker, strong drink is raging; and whosoever is deceived thereby is not wise."

Do we need to quote further from God's Word to show the folly of this young man's course of action and of the faculty's permissiveness?

With familiar neo-evangelical double talk the writer of this article, John Goodwin, does admit that some of the lad's converts, as well as some of the older Christians joining his movement became problem drinkers, but he doesn't condemn this form of "Christian witness"; indeed he argues that the professors themselves couldn't find Scripture to condemn it, for "worldliness," he says, *"is* a matter of the affection... internal rather than external."

But as we consider the four eases we have cited above from *Christianity Today* and *Action* magazine, how can we erase from our minds the words of Paul: *"What part hath he that believeth with an unbeliever?... Wherefore come ye out from among them, and be ye separate"* (II Cor. 6:15-17). How can we forget his own testimony: *"The world is crucified unto me, and I unto the world"* (Gal. 6:14). Most of all, how can we help but be arrested by the words of James:

"Ye adulterers and adulteresses, know ye not that the friendship of the world is enmity with God? Whosoever therefore will be a friend of the world is the enemy of God" (Jas. 4:4).

SEPARATION--A STAND

Robert O. Ferm joins Goodwin in arguing that "true separation is of the heart and is never a mechanical isolation."[114] But is this true? Is not separation also *a*

[114] *Co-operative Evangelism,* P. 34.

stand if it is truly of the heart? We read that Obadiah, the governor of Ahab's house "feared the Lord greatly" (I Kings 18:3) but he was a secret believer, afraid to take an open stand with the prophet Elijah and even begged Elijah not to get him into a difficult position for his beliefs (Vers. 7-14).

The three Hebrew worthies were more noble than this. They stood bold and erect as the thousands about them grovelled before an image of gold. And when King Nebuchadnezzar called them to account for failing to bow before his image and threatened to throw them into a burning fiery furnace if they further rebelled, they replied:

"If it be so, our God whom we serve is able to deliver us from the burning fiery furnace...

"BUT IF NOT, BE IT KNOWN UNTO THEE, O KING, THAT WE WILL NOT SERVE THY GODS, NOR WORSHIP THE GOLDEN IMAGE WHICH THOU HAST SET UP" (Dan. 3:17,18).

These men could have reasoned thus: God knows that we love Him, that if we bow before these idols we do not do so in our hearts. He would surely have us obey the rulers in the land where we are captives. Besides, if we are killed our testimony for God will thus be completely cut off.

But these noble Hebrews did *not* reason thus. They knew that true separation to God demands a stand. They took this stand and God signally honored them for it.

So, let our backsliding neo-evangelical brethren talk about "inclusivist methods," "less separatism" and more "friendly involvement" with the world. But by God's grace let us take a stand against this friendship with the world and with apostasy.

The fight will not be easy, for scores of additional cases could be cited to show how strong is the inclination among many spiritual leaders today to introduce worldliness into the Church--and many quotations from neo-evangelical writers could be advanced. One notable case is that of Edward John Carnell, formerly a professor at *Fuller Theological Seminary* and now lately deceased.

Ridiculing the fundamentalists, Carnell wrote in his book, *The Case for Orthodoxy: "...* the fundamentalist is virtuous because he does not smoke, dance, or play cards .... And the fundamentalist defends his negations in the name of the very Lord who came that men might have life, and have it more abundantly."[115] This is amazing! Would even a permissive Christian suppose that smoking, dancing, or playing cards have any connection whatever with the "abundant life" which our Lord would have us enjoy?

[115] Pp. 120, 124.

This is only one example of Carnell's views on the subject, as his book is but one example of hundreds that are helping to obliterate the distinction between the Church and the world.

As we have previously pointed out, neo-evangelicalism is extremely subtle, extremely well financed and extremely popular. This is why we agree with a statement by Dr. Bob Jones, Jr., with reference to modernism, neo-orthodoxy and the new evangelicalism. "Of these three," says Dr. Jones, "the last group is the most dangerous, since it is the most subtle, the most persuasive, and the most influential in bringing Bible believers into compromise. It persuades them that it is not necessary to stand against infidelity or to press the battle against unbelief. So God's people, having laid down their arms, will find themselves quickly conquered and enslaved."[116]

The present controversy, we are convinced, will separate not only the brainwashed from those who are more aware of Satan's devices; it will also separate the men from the boys, spiritually, or the Obadiahs from the Hebrew worthies. God give us grace to *stand* with the Hebrew worthies!

BE YE SEPARATE

There is one passage of Scripture which obviously troubles the neo-evangelicals most. This is II Cor. 6:14-18, which their representatives have misquoted, half-quoted, misinterpreted and even, in some cases, have all but ridiculed, but they have never faced up to it. They can't, because they are disobeying it. Let us, then, see what this important passage from God's Word says:

"Be ye not unequally yoked together with unbelievers: for what fellowship hath righteousness with unrighteousness? and what communion hath light with darkness?

"And what concord hath Christ with Belial? or what part hath he that believeth with an infidel?

"And what agreement hath the temple of God with idols? for ye are the temple of the living God; as God hath said, I will dwell in them, and walk in them; and I will be their God, and they shall be My people.

"Wherefore come out from among them, and be ye separate, saith the Lord, and touch not the unclean thing;, and I will receive you,

"And will be a Father unto you, and ye shall be My sons and daughters, saith the Lord Almighty."

Could God have stated more clearly what the believer's attitude should be toward the world---even the apostate religious world?

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[116] *The Four Groups in Protestantism, P. 6.*

Righteousness, unrighteousness; light, darkness; Christ, Belial; the believer, the unbeliever--what fellowship can there be, or should there be, between these?

Moreover, believers in Christ are the temple of God. A temple is not a mere building; it is a *sacred* building, a *shrine* consecrated to *worship.* How can we defile and desecrate this temple by worldly or apostate associations? This temple is for *Him,* for Him *alone.*

“Wherefore come out from among them, and be ye separate... and touch not the unclean thing.... "

This demands a clear-cut stand and it is on this basis alone that the passage continues:

"... and I will receive you.

"And will be a Father unto you, and ye shall be My sons and daughters, saith the Lord Almighty."

There is a great difference between *having* God as our Father and *enjoying* Him as our Father. A disappointed young husband once said to this writer: "Dad never was a father to me," adding that he hoped for a closer relationship with *his* children.

God too would have a close and affectionate relationship with His children but this is possible only as we consecrate ourselves wholly to Him, as members of His Church (called-out ones), separate from the world and apostate religion.

If we truly desire this closeness of fellowship with God, and the spiritual liberty and power that accompany it, *He* surely will not fail us. Indeed, He has already given us His complete armor; has placed "the shield of faith" in one hand and "the Sword of the Spirit" in the other, and has promised us His grace in the fight to *"stand . . . withstand . . . and having done all, to stand"* (Eph. 6:10-17) so that Satan's wiles may not succeed in driving the slightest wedge between Him and us.

Chapter VIII

THE NEW EVANGELICALISM AND APOSTATE RELIGION

THE BIBLE AND APOSTATE RELIGION

The Scriptural doctrine of sanctification involves separation to God from this world system *including apostate religion.*

Many people suppose that if an organization is religious it must therefore be good and pleasing to God. Nothing could be farther from the truth, for "our adversary the devil" does his work principally in the *spiritual* realm. As the "prince of this world" (John 14:30) and the "god of this age" (II Cor. 4:4) it is no credit to him when a drunkard staggers down the street or a harlot disgraces the neighborhood. He advocates righteousness--self-righteousness that denies the need of salvation by grace through the redeeming blood of Christ. Referring to the "false apostles," the "deceitful workers" of his day, the Apostle Paul says:

"And no marvel; for Satan himself is transformed into an angel of light.

'Therefore it is no great thing if his ministers also be transformed as the ministers of righteousness; whose end shall be according to their works" (II Cor. 11:14,15).

Thus the believer should be always on guard against "the wiles of the devil" in this area, for a clergyman with a sweet, religious disposition, preaching love and righteousness, may well be a minister of Satan. Hence the importance of testing a man's preaching by the fundamentals of the faith as found in the Word of God: the divine inspiration and inerrancy of the Bible, the deity of Christ, His vicarious death, His bodily resurrection, etc. Fidelity to these essential doctrines must come even before his views as to the distinctiveness of Paul's apostleship and ministry, important as this is.

Robert P. Lightner has well said: "The Church has been commissioned with a two-fold responsibility for every age the preservation and propagation of the faith."[117]

NEO-EVANGELICAL LAXITY IN THIS AREA

We have already pointed out the weakness of neo-evangelicalism's "stand" for the fundamentals of the faith and many men of God have written on this subject. To quote Lightner further:

[117] *Neo-Evangelicalism,* P. 161.

"The very fact that the new evangelicalism proposes to mediate between liberalism and fundamentalism precludes the fact that it will be very vociferous in favor of the doctrine of separation."[118]

"Neo-evangelicalism has little sympathy with any group which has left a denomination because it believed in unity enough to be concerned with the purity of its doctrine."[119]

THE DOCTRINE OF THE ONE BODY

Leading neo-evangelicals, including Ronald H, Nash, have condemned Dr. Machen and other fundamentalists for leaving their denominations when those denominations departed from the faith. Says Nash:

"Evangelicalism accuses twentieth-century separatism of departing from the New Testament doctrine of the Church, particularly, its teaching of the organic and spiritual unity of the Body of Christ."[120]

Nash errs here on several grounds. First, he assumes that those who deny the fundamentals of the faith are members of the Body of Christ. Second, it is no violation of the doctrine of the one Body to refuse to subscribe to doctrines which one does not believe. An honest Bible believer could not, for example, consistently remain a member of a religious organization that denies the deity of Christ. Third, the same apostle whose writings have so much to say about the unity of the one Body, also has much to say about the believer's attitude toward apostates and even disorderly brethren, and he bids us in no uncertain terms to *separate* ourselves from them. We cite several passages as examples:

"Now I beseech you, brethren, mark them which cause divisions and offences contrary to the doctrine which ye have learned, and AVOID THEM" (Rom, 16:17),

"Be ye not unequally yoked together with unbelievers, for…

"... what part hath he that believeth with an infidel [unbeliever]?

"WHEREFORE COME OUT FROM AMONG THEM, AND BE YE SEPARATE.. . and I will receive you" (II Cor. 6:14-17).

"Now we command you, brethren, in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ, that ye WITHDRAW YOURSELVES from every brother that walketh disorderly ..." (II Thes. 3:6).

"And if any man obey not our word by this epistle, note that man, and HAVE NO COMPANY WITH HIM, that he may be ashamed" (II Thes. 3:14).

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[118] *Ibid.,* P. 95.
[119] *Ibid.,* P. 96.
[120] *The New Evangelicalism,* P. 94.

"If any man teach otherwise, and consent not to wholesome words, even the words of our Lord Jesus Christ [Cf. II Cor. 13:2,3] ....

"... FROM SUCH WITHDRAW THYSELF" (I Tim. 6:3-5).

"Having a form of godliness, but denying the power thereof: FROM SUCH TURN AWAY" (II Tim. 3:5).

"LET US GO FORTH THEREFORE UNTO HIM, WITHOUT THE CAMP, BEARING HIS REPROACH" (Heb. 13:13).

"The camp" in the last passage above, was apostate Israel. "The camp" today is the apostate Church, popular organized religion. "The camp" today is no less corrupt than was "the camp" in Paul's day.

But despite the clear teaching of Scripture on this subject, Nash condemns separation from the apostate denominations as a "surrender to liberalism." He reasons as follows:

"The separatists left whole denominations, together with their seminaries, churches and agencies, in the hands of the liberals. We are not denying that at the time of withdrawal the liberals were in control of these things. But does that mean that every time that the balance of power swings away from us that we should cease being a minority voice? Does this warrant our surrender of the *whole* every time the liberals are in the majority? Now, thirty years later, orthodoxy has little voice within many of these influential areas of the Church."[121]

Here again Nash ignores the fact that a true believer would have to be dishonest to remain a member of an apostate denomination and subscribe to doctrines which he did not believe. In fact he goes even farther in this disregard for Christian integrity.

THE DOCTRINE OF INFILTRATION

Nash is one of those who proclaims the amazing doctrine of "infiltration." And whom does he cite to back him up in this? None other than Harold John Ockenga, the "father of neo-evangelicalism." Here is what Nash says on the subject:

"Harold John Ockenga has made it clear that one of the primary objectives of evangelicalism is the recapture of 'denominational leadership from within the denominations rather than abandoning these denominations to modernism.' The strategy or method that Ockenga recommends is 'infiltration.' He points out that this was the very means the liberals used to gain control of the major religious bodies in the first place. He urges, 'It is time for firm evangelicals to seize their opportunity to minister in and influence modernist groups. Why is it incredible that the

[121] *Ibid.,* Pp. 94,95.

evangelicals should be able to infiltrate the denominations and strengthen the things that remain, and possibly resume control of such denominations?'"[122]

Just imagine the implications! First, we must move in surreptitiously with the liberals, infiltrating their ranks as one with them! The liberals entered and won control of fundamentalist denominations in this way so, dishonest or not, why shouldn't we use the same strategy to regain control!

But further, the adoption of this strategy would mean that we must subject ourselves, our wives and our children to apostate teachings week after week for long periods of time in order to achieve our objective. Is not this bound to do us all spiritual harm and to neutralize our stand for the truth? Nash says: "The evangelical is not afraid or hesitant to fight for his faith,"[123] but he prescribes the very methods that are most apt to water down his faith.

This doctrine of infiltration is not unlike the neo-evangelical view as to the believer and the world. The neo-evangelical urges believers to get involved with the world; go where they go, do what they do (unless it is really very sinful !) so as to win them to Christ. Likewise he urges believers to get in with apostate liberals, to join their churches and denominations in order to win them, *or* to gain control of their organizations. But God says no to both because this strategy is basically dishonest and detrimental to our spiritual well-being.

The doctrine of infiltration minimizes the danger of apostate teachings. Think alone of Acts 20:29-31, where the Apostle Paul declares that for three years he had not ceased to warn the Ephesian believers night and day with tears about the danger of apostates infiltrating their ranks from without and heretics arising from within to draw them away from God and His message of grace. And should *we* now infiltrate the ranks of liberal apostates? God forbid!

Some years ago Dr. Ockenga said: "The younger orthodox scholars are repudiating the separatist position…."[124] Clearly he, Nash, and other neo-evangelicals have also repudiated it, but in doing so they have disobeyed the clear Word of God. This is not to deny that some fundamentalists have pressed the doctrine of separation too far, but it is to emphasize the fact that the Scriptures do emphatically command the believer's separation from this world system and from apostate religion.

THE RESULTS OF COMPROMISE

When the Bible doctrine of separation is minimized the results are often appalling, for one compromise leads to another as the distinction between true Christianity and apostate religion and the world is gradually erased.

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[122] *Ibid.,* P. 95.
[123] *Ibid.,* P. 96.
[124] "Resurgent Evangelical Leadership," *Christianity Today,* Oct. 10, 1960.

A sad example of this is the father of neo-evangelicalism himself, Dr. Harold J. Ockenga.

At the special service commemorating the 150th Anniversary of the famous *Park Street Church* of Boston, one would have expected Dr. Ockenga, the pastor, to gather round him great men of God, champions of the faith. Doubtless some men of God did participate, but it is sad that the *New Bedford Standard-Times* of Feb. 28, 1959, commenting on the celebration, could say:

"The 1600 diners.. . heard the pastor of their church, the Rev. Harold J. Ockenga, review the founding and guiding principles of the church .... Other speakers included Representative Laurence Curtis (R. Mass.), Lieutenant Governor Murphy, State Senator John E. Powers (D. Boston), the Rev. Dana McLean Greely, president of the American Unitarian Association; the Very Rev. Charles H. Buck, Jr., dean of the Cathedral Church of St. Paul, representing the Episcopal Diocese of Massachusetts, and Erwin D. Canham, editor of the Christian Science Monitor."[125]

This is unspeakably sad, but not inconsistent with Ockenga's philosophy. If we believers are to infiltrate apostate churches, what is the matter with having politicians, Unitarians and Christian Scientists speak in ours?

Another sad example of the results of compromise is that of Dr. Donald Grey Barnhouse, long pastor of Philadelphia's *Tenth Presbyterian Church* and now deceased.

In the early thirties Dr. Barnhouse was one of the country's most militant defenders of fundamentalism. A brilliant Bible teacher, he was outspoken in his opposition to modernism in his own Presbyterian denomination. Once, when the Philadelphia Presbytery met in his own church and held a communion service, he walked out in protest against the apostate beliefs held by members of that body. He denounced the *Federal* (now *National*) *Council of Churches* for its modernism and its leanings toward communism.

But he remained in the denomination, the *Presbyterian Church, U.S.A.,* which was, in turn, a member of the *Federal Council of Churches.*

For a time Dr. Barnhouse held Sunday afternoon services in Philadelphia's *Chestnut Street Opera House* in order to reach the general public with fundamental Bible teaching. But when the Presbytery complained that the services were hurting the other (mostly modernist) Presbyterian churches in the area, he bowed to the Presbytery and discontinued the services. Likewise, when he was ordered by the Presbyterian Assembly to resign from the *Independent Board of Presbyterian Foreign Missions,* he yielded and resigned.

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[125] Quoted from the *Standard-Times* by Wm. E. Ashbrook in *The New Neutralism,* P. 9.

We are well acquainted with the above facts, for in those days Dr. Barnhouse was a frequent guest at our home, usually for a week at a time, while he ministered at Bible conferences in Paterson, N.J.

Loudly as Dr. Barnhouse declaimed against modernism, his defection had already begun and this writer's father, Mr. Peter Stam, told him so. When Dr. Machen and other faithful men of God left the church, refusing to be yoked together with apostate unbelievers, Dr. Barnhouse remained. He defended his position by arguing, as the neo-evangelicals now do, that true believers *should* remain in modernist churches to exert what good influence they might. In reality he was compromising with apostasy.

In 1933 we had a discussion with Dr. Barnhouse about water baptism. Unavoidable circumstances terminated the discussion but he promised to publish a clear statement of his stand on this subject in the July issue of *Revelation* magazine. What was our astonishment, though, to find instead an editorial in which he failed to set forth *his* view, but said with regard to our stand for the "one baptism": "Those who arrange Bible conferences and who select special speakers should be on guard and refuse to invite those who hold these false views."

Thus he sought to gag the testimony of men who stood true to the faith, because they could not agree as to water baptism with the hundreds of preachers who could not even agree with each other--and this while he himself was still denominationally affiliated with men who denied the very fundamentals of the faith.

This stand did not differ greatly from that of Ronald H. Nash, who has much to say against "separatism," yet declares that there is a "clear-cut" and "important" "contrast" "separating" evangelicalism from fundamentalism.[126]

From this time on Dr. Barnhouse did much to oppose our proclamation of the Pauline message, with its "one body" and "one baptism." At the same time he continued to move ever closer to the modernists.

In 1954 he apologized--to the wrong people. In a statement addressed to the Presbytery he said: "In my earlier years I fought against anything I thought had in it a small percentage of error. But while outwardly critical of some of the church's program, I have always considered myself to be a Presbyterian. ... In the moment of the Presbytery's greatest controversy[127] I accepted every ruling of the Presbytery and bowed to its decisions. However, I have come to realize that some of my personal relationships have suffered because of these past differences and I now recognize that this has been a mistake."

Thus did the "fearless" Dr. Barnhouse apologize for his former stand for the truth of God to a denomination now more modernistic than ever.

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[126] *Op. cit.,* Preface.

[127] When Dr. Machen was suspended by the General Assembly in connection with his stand for thee fundamentals; an action which Dr. Barnhouse then called "iniquity" and "blasphemy."

Soon after, on Nov. 12, 1954, a report appeared in the Philadelphia *Evening Bulletin,* stating: *"The* Presbytery, in an open-arm gesture of welcome, has unanimously endorsed a series of television programs prepared by Dr. Barnhouse, to be produced by the *National Council of Churches* .... "Whether this select TV opportunity had anything to do with Dr. Barnhouse's apology to the Presbytery we do not know, but we do know that this attached him more closely than ever to modernists, pinks and worse.

From here on Dr. Barnhouse's declension went on apace. He talked and wrote much about the joy and blessing of "wider Christian fellowship," and less and less about the dangers of apostatizing from the truth.

Many sincere Christians were touched by this humble and loving attitude and began to talk about "the new Dr. Barnhouse." Actually he was one of the first neo-evangelicals, pressing now for less separation, more fellowship with liberals, even hobnobbing with leaders of the *National* and *World* Councils of Churches and writing in glowing terms about Dr. Josef Hromadka, one of their leading spokesmen and representative from Communist Russia.

But in the twilight of his ministry Dr. Barnhouse was to stray still farther from a clear, firm stand for the truths he had so courageously championed in his earlier years.

In Dec. 1957, he was a featured speaker, along with Dr. Ockenga and Billy Graham, at the annual missionary program of the *Intervarsity Christian Fellowship,* held at the *University of Illinois.* The theme: "One Lord, One Church, One World." Here Dr. Barnhouse ridiculed fundamentalists in general and Luther, Calvin and other Protestant Reformers in particular, for their faithfulness to the Bible doc-trine of separation. One would have concluded that the Reformation was a great mistake. Boasting that his new stand had gained him radio and television ministries from the *National Council of Churches,* he went so far in holding fundamentalism up to ridicule that WMBI, the *Moody Bible Institute* radio station, had to cut him off the air.

It is significant that with all the "wider fellowship" which Dr. Barnhouse now boasted, he still kept aloof from those who stood--and' still stand--for *"the preaching of Jesus Christ according to the revelation of the mystery,"* and even continued to brand them as heretics.[128]

This is how compromise with apostasy works. Admit "a little leaven" and it will surely "leaven the whole lump" (I Cor. 5:6; Gal. 5:9). This applies to the grace movement and its various organizations no less than to fundamentalism in general. May God in His grace keep us pure in doctrine and conduct.

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[128] For more complete information as to Dr. Barnhouse's attitude toward the "grace movement," see the author's book The *Controversy*

Chapter IX

THE NEW EVANGELICALISM AND EVANGELISM

EVANGELISTIC CHALLENGE

What an evangelistic challenge has confronted the Church of Christ for the past two decades! Through radio and television literally millions of people could hear about Christ again and again on regular programs--people who could not previously have been reached. Through greatly improved printing techniques the masses in foreign lands could be reached with Christian literature. Through advanced means of transportation it has been possible for missionaries to travel to the far corners of the earth with great speed and comparatively little inconvenience. This has indeed been the Church's great opportunity to evangelize the world!

Among those who have risen to meet this challenge and to take advantage of the opportunity, the neo-evangelicals have been the biggest, the richest, the most intellectual, the most sophisticated and the best organized. Moreover they have had the backing of some of the largest Christian periodicals, including *Christianity Today, United Evangelical Action* and *Christian Life.* Indeed, even radio, television and the secular press have been largely sympathetic toward neo-evangelicalism and its leaders.

Undoubtedly the neo-evangelicals' motive has been commendable. It was their desire and determination to reach the masses for Christ, to bring spiritual revival to the Church and to reverse the trend of evil in the world. But with all their money, brain power, magnificent organization and public exposure they have definitely *not,* in all these years, accomplished what they set out to do. Neo-evangelicalism has been weighed in the balance and found wanting.

Does some reader protest that he knows of certain individuals who have been gloriously saved, thoroughly converted, through the ministry of a neo-evangelical? We reply that this only proves that the Word of God, through the operation of the Spirit, is still doing its regenerating work. This does not alter the fact that neo-evangelicalism, as a movement, has failed.

Through radio and television neo-evangelical leaders have often reached greater audiences in one single service than earlier evangelists reached in their entire careers. Their plans have been carefully laid and skillfully executed; thousands, in city after city, have raised their hands or have come forward to indicate, acceptance of Christ as Savior. Follow-up procedures have been carried out to keep in touch with the converts. Never in all history has so much been done with such superb organization to evangelize America and the world.

Yet proportionate results are lacking. While church membership in America rose for a time it soon declined again, and is steadily continuing to decline. In Great

Britain only 2% of the population attend church--any church. True believers, more and more, are finding themselves in the minority--and certainly there has been no revival in the Body of Christ. Rather, Christians, on the whole, are becoming more and more indifferent and worldly. As a result, the whole professing Church is being ridiculed-often justly--by the world. Godlessness, apostasy and immorality are the order of the day. Violence and crime are not merely increasing; they are skyrocketing, so that in most American cities of any size it is becoming increasingly dangerous even to walk the streets at night.

By contrast the awakenings under Luther, Calvin, Wesley and Darby each made a profound impression upon society at large. Under the ministries of these men of God and their associates, not only were souls saved and the Church revived, but in many cases rulers trembled as all society felt the impact. Yet in the past twenty years of "big time" evangelism-the biggest ever--no such results have followed.

There are some who would explain away the failure of modern evangelism by arguing that the last days are upon us, but this argument is not valid. It does indeed appear that we may be living in the very closing days of the dispensation of grace, but it must never be overlooked that these last days, as described in Paul's epistles, reflect *the condition of the Church.*

Thoughtful, separated Bible believers, even those who have not been fully aware of the dangers of the new evangelicalism, must finally come to the conclusion that *neo-evangelicalism has failed.* Why has it failed? This we will now consider in the light of the Word of God. As we do we will find that the failure is due to a three-fold weakness: *doctrinal, dispensational* and *spiritual.*

DOCTRINAL WEAKNESS
THEOLOGICAL LAXITY

We have already seen how lax on doctrine the neo-evangelicals are. They have dismally failed to "fight the good fight of the faith," unless fighting includes only intellectual exchanges. Indeed, many of them have failed to obey the divine command to "stand fast in the faith."

This was nowhere more evident than at the recent *World Congress on Evangelism* headed up by Carl Henry, Billy Graham, Harold J. Ockenga and other leading neo-evangelicals. As we have pointed out, Dr. Richard Wurmbrand, fourteen years a prisoner for Christ at the hands of the Communists, and cruelly tortured, was denied participation in the Congress. Why? Mr. Zoefi, the Associate Director for arrangements for the Congress explained: "Many of the brethren from the Eastern countries will be obtaining visas only because they have assured their governments that this Congress will not deal with anything that borders on political matters, such as Communism and so forth."[129]

[129] For the full statement see the Feb., 1967 issue of the *Berean Searchlight.*

Thus the Congress excluded this man of God who truly represents the world's martyr Church, and made concessions to Communist countries so as to welcome men of whom Wurmbrand says: "I can assure you that . . . if anybody comes [from these countries] you can put your hand in the fire that he is a man of the Secret Police."[130] Since that time the *Church League of America* has indeed identified some of these "clergymen" as Soviet secret agents.

How was the Congress opened? With an address by the Emperor Haile Selassie I, who since 1930 has allowed himself to be heralded as "King of Kings" and "the Lion of Judah." A major address was also delivered by Bishop Chandu Ray of Pakistan, Chairman of the *Commission on Mission and Evangelism* of the *World Council of Churches*--hardly a strong fundamentalist! Some liberals participated, along with some outstanding conservatives, including Dr. Wm. Culbertson, Dr. Paul Rees, Bob Pierce, Dr. Theodore Epp and healer Oral Roberts.

At the close of the Congress a manifesto was issued, based on its slogan: *One Race, One Gospel, One Task.* This manifesto described the Congress as an "evangelical, ecumenical gathering," pledging itself to "the evangelization of the human race in this generation." The manifesto had much to say about civil rights and the equality of the races, but as to doctrine it was most ambiguous. Even though the Congress' first and most fundamental objective was "to define and clarify Biblical evangelism for our day," it failed to show clearly how evangelism is related to the Bible, either doctrinally or dispensationally. The Congress was a theological hodge-podge at which doctrine necessarily had to be soft-pedaled to achieve "unity for the sake of evangelism." Thus the manifesto states: "We implore the world church to obey the divine commission," without even attempting to define the word "church," or explain which commission! Little wonder John B. Sheerin, a Paulist priest, present as an observer, wrote:

"The *doctrinal* unity evident at the Second Vatican Council found no parallel at the Congress. Carl Henry said, 'It is well for us evangelicals to remember what a dappled and diverse company we are.' For the delegates had come from all over the world and from disparate backgrounds and theologies which were reflected in their diverse and dissonant interpretations of the Bible.

"Yet before the Congress was over, they had blended into a warm fellowship. Only the Holy Spirit, working through Billy Graham as the human instrument, could have welded together so quickly so many men of different creeds. The spirit of Pope John hovered over the Council [He means the Congress]."[131]

This is the kind of unity Rome has always sought--and sought to enforce: union by compromise. This "unity" is not based on the Word of God; it is the "unity" which will hold the coming Church of Antichrist together. The Paulist priest viewed this as the work of the Holy Spirit but it is certainly not the work referred to in I Cor. 12:13, in which only true believers are included. Nor is this "unity" the "unity of *the Spirit"* referred to in Eph. 4:3. It is rather a "unity of *spirit"* which sacrifices conviction to

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[130] *Ibid.*
[131] *The Catholic Voice,* Nov. 16, 1966.

unite on those few details which are agreed upon. Such a spirit must of necessity whittle doctrine down to a minimum and pay little heed to *what God has said in His Word* about many important matters.

Not long after the Congress Graham appeared along with Vice President Humphrey at the liberal *National Council of Churches* convention in Miami and told them: "One of the objects of the Congress on Evangelism was to gather some of these elements together along with some of the people of the conciliar [ecumenical] movement."

Let no one conclude from the above that we do not heartily thank God for every person truly saved through Billy Graham's ministry. Billy quotes a lot of Scripture and God uses His Word. But what can justify the unholy mixture at the Berlin Congress? What place did Bible-believing Christians have there? *"What communion hath light with darkness? And what concord hath Christ with Belial? Or what part hath he that believeth with an unbeliever?"* We love these brethren in the Lord and appreciate their desire to win souls to Christ, but how will they answer to God for ignoring such important passages of Scripture as II Cor. 11:14,15; II Cor. 6:14-17; II Thes. 3:14; I Tim. 6:3-5 and Heb. 13:13, which warn us of Satan's attempts to neutralize our stand and command us: *"Be not unequally yoked together with unbelievers"; "come out from among them";* and even *"withdraw yourselves," "have no company with" and "turn away"* from those who profess the truth but deny it by their lives.

Great Britain's Errol Hulse is doubtless correct in saying: "There is more meaning, substance and teaching concerning God, Man and Redemption in four or five pages of that [Westminster] Confession than there is in the two books which report the Congress at Berlin, put together!"[132]

How could neo-evangelicalism *but* fail while it is not rounded solidly on the doctrines of the Word of God?

ARMINIANISM

Perhaps the strongest attempt at the Congress to relate evangelism to Bible doctrine was made by Dr. Harold J. Ockenga, neo-evangelicalism's "father." Speaking for the new evangelicalism, he read a prepared paper on "The Basic Theology of Evangelism," in which he said:

"Some Reformed theologians teach that regeneration by the Holy Spirit precedes conversion. The evangelical position is that regeneration is conditioned upon repentance, confession and faith. This alone stimulates evangelism."

Dr. Ockenga may feel that this view stimulates evangelism, but it is nevertheless contrary to the clear Word of God. Ockenga overlooks the fact that while *regeneration* does not precede faith, *conviction* does precede it, and this too

[132] *The Banner of Truth,* May, June, 1967.

is the Spirit's work for, *"when He [the Holy Spirit] is come, He will reprove the world of sin, and of righteousness, and of judgment"* (John 16:8).

The Greek *elenko* here is variously rendered "rebuke," "reprove," "convince" and "convict," but always has the sense of rebuking with a view to making ashamed (See John 8:9). This is the work of the Holy Spirit in the *unbeliever.* Ockenga is typical of the new evangelicalism, riddled as it is with Arminianism. Billy Graham himself, when questioned about this subject in 1966, answered:

"Unfortunately, God has no power over the will of man. That is to say, He cannot save a person against his will . . . salvation depends upon man's willingness to be saved... The Bible indicates that God will do everything short of coercion to redeem people, but even He cannot save them against their will."[133]

It is true that God *does not* save people against their wills, but it is fully as true that it is He who, by the Spirit, *makes* men willing. If ("unfortunately") "God has no power over the will of man," what is meant by such passages as Acts 16:14, where we read of Lydia:

"WHOSE HEART THE LORD OPENED, that she attended unto the things which were spoken of [by] Paul."

And what is meant by Psa. 110:3:

"Thy people shall be willing in the day of Thy power.. ."

And what is meant by John 6:44:

"No man can come to Me, except the Father which hath sent Me draw him ..."

And what is meant by all the great Scripture passages on election and predestination (Think of Eph. 1:1-12 alone!)? Shall we erase these from our Bibles and set man above God so that man can now command God? Doesn't God *have to* save us if we wish it, since Christ died for our sins? And can it be that God had to lay His eternal plans on the basis of what lost sinners would some day do? Perish the thought!

When we believers are finally caught up to be "forever with the Lord," we will not *in any degree* attribute our salvation to ourselves. We will say with heartfelt thanks: "By God's grace I was chosen in Christ before the foundation of the world. The Spirit convicted me of sin, revealed to me my need of a Savior, showed me Christ's glorious, all-sufficient payment for my sins, opened my heart to receive Him by faith and so justified and glorified me. It was all, *all* by His grace."

DISPENSATIONAL WEAKNESS

[133] *The Standard Bearer,* Nov., 1966.

Another reason for neo-evangelicalism's failure is *dispensational* in character. Neo-evangelicals are working under *the wrong commission,* a commission which God Himself has rendered impossible to fulfill today. This error, sad to say, was inherited from the fundamentalists.

Most fundamentalists have always held that the commission which our Lord gave to His eleven apostles is binding upon us today, that it constitutes the Church's "marching orders." But the legalism of Matt. 28:20, the baptismal salvation and miraculous signs of Mark 16:16-18, the "Jerusalem first" of Luke 24:47 and the "absolution" of John 20:22,23, have all been superseded by instructions which the glorified Lord later revealed through the Apostle Paul. Thus the fundamentalists who held to the "great commission" were by no means agreed as to *which record* of the commission was for our obedience (as though they had a right to choose!). Hence the confusion and division in the ranks of the fundamentalists which made united evangelistic effort impossible.

It was this difficulty that gave rise to the new evangelicalism. The trouble was, though, that the neo-evangelical leaders also failed to see, or refused to see, the unique apostolic authority of Paul, God's new apostle, for our day. They sought to bring about unity and renewed evangelistic effort by urging Christians to be "big" and to unite on the basis of those truths on which they did agree. This is how Bible doctrine has now been given a place secondary to evangelism and how sincere convictions on the part of believers have been stifled. Getting souls saved, seemingly, is more important than listening to what God says, or finding out from His Word, just what it is He wishes us to do; whether or not the commission to the eleven *is* also our commission.

That the neo-evangelical leaders do believe that the commission to the eleven constitutes our marching orders is hardly open to discussion. We do not know of a single one who questions this. Referring to this so-called "great commission," Dr. Ockenga says:

"... God has a program for His Church. This I learned from the Bible, especially from the post-resurrection commandments of our Lord Jesus Christ. We cannot evade the fact that He commanded His followers to take the Gospel to every creature and to make disciples of all nations."

"... only one Gospel is taught by all of the writers of the New Testament, including Paul, who says, 'I received my Gospel not by a man but by revelation of Jesus Christ.'"[134]

This is the basic view of the leaders of neo-evangelicalism, as it was--and is---of most of the leaders of fundamentalism. The neo-evangelicals, however, have strayed even farther than the fundamentalists from the Pauline revelation and further back into the teachings of the earthly Jesus, when He was still "a minister of the Circumcision... to confirm the promises made unto the [Hebrew] fathers" (Rom. 15:8). For example:

[134] "Church With a Global Shadow," *Christian Reader*, Feb., March 1966.

Eric S. Fife and Arthur F. Glasser join in saying: "'The gospel must first be published among all nations.' With this forthright, unambiguous statement Christ described the basic condition His Church must fulfill before He returns to consummate this present age."[135]

The statement to which these brethren refer is indeed unambiguous, but it was made while the prophesied establishment of our Lord's kingdom was still being proclaimed and long before the interruption of the prophetic program by a special revelation committed to Paul.

Our Lord, in Matt. 24:14 and Mark 13:10, was not referring to "the gospel of the grace of God," but to *"this gospel of the kingdom."* Nor was he referring to the consummation of *this present* age. He was speaking of His prophesied return to earth to judge and reign. By comparison *this present interruption of the prophetic program* will be brought to a close by our rapture to glory to be with Christ.

If there is *any* "condition His Church must fulfill before He returns to consummate this present age," then:

The Thessalonian believers were foolish to *"wait for His [God's] Son from heaven"* (I Thes. 1:10).

Paul was wrong and the Scriptures inconsistent for instructing the Philippian believers to *"look for the Savior, the Lord Jesus Christ" to* come for them (Phil. 3:20).

Paul should not have urged Titus to be *"looking for that blessed hope and the appearing in glory of the great God and our Savior Jesus Christ"* (Tit. 2:13).

The Corinthians were deceived in *"waiting for the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ"* (I Cor. 1:7).

It was idle for the Thessalonian believers to "*comfort one another"* with the hope of Christ's coming for them (I Thes. 4:18).

In a word, if Matt. 24:14 or *any* condition must be fulfilled before our Lord's coming *for His Body* it is pointless to talk about the imminent coming of Christ for His own--a doctrine so strongly emphasized in Paul's inspired epistles.

As we have seen, Carl Henry has also gone back into the records of Christ's earthly ministry for guidance as to evangelism today. He closes an article titled, "Evangelize: The Order of the Day," with these words:

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[135] *Missions in Crisis*, P. 58.

"Let evangelicals not only proclaim redemption in the face of impending judgment, but also 'preach, saying, the Kingdom of heaven is at hand.' Never was evangelism more needed than in this apocalyptic age."[136]

But when our Lord sent His twelve apostles out to proclaim this message, he added:

"Heal the sick, cleanse the lepers, raise the dead, cast out devils [demons]" (Matt. 10:8).

Does Dr. Henry obey *this* command? And if in his heart he feels he should, what about the rest:

"Freely ye have received, freely give. Provide neither gold, nor silver, nor brass in your purses.

"Nor scrip for your journey, neither two coats, neither shoes, nor yet staves: for the workman is worthy of his meat" (Vers. 8-10).

Does Dr. Henry go about without a dollar, or a quarter or even a penny in his possession? Does he have the right to choose which of Christ's commands he wishes to obey?

It is interesting indeed that Dr. Henry should seek to bind upon us a commission in which our Lord clearly instructed His apostles *not* to go to the Gentiles, but to "go rather to the lost sheep of the house of Israel!" But to get back to our original argument: It is interesting that many neo-evangelicals *are* endeavoring (vainly) to recover the sign gifts, as found in Matt. 10:8, but they do not obey the rest of the command. They cannot say with Peter: *"Silver and gold have I none"* (Acts 3:6). The May, 1967, issue of *Christian Life* carries an article by R. Archer Torrey III on "The Total Commission," in which he quotes Matt. 10:7,8, concerning healing the sick and raising the dead, and asks: "Why do we so often ignore this facet of the presentation of the Gospel of Christ?" But if this command is for our obedience should we not also ask regarding the rest of this command ("Provide neither gold, nor silver, nor brass in your purses"): "Why do we ignore this?" We have yet to find one faith "healer" who obeys Christ's command to sell all his possessions and give to the poor (Luke 12:33). How true were the words of A. E. Bishop half a century ago:

"What injury to the cause of Christ, what distress to babes in Christ, what heart-rending, faith-destroying disasters would be avoided by dividing the Word aright..."

Another result of this dispensational error is seen in the various slogans: "America for God," "America for Christ," "Europe for Christ," etc.

God has never yet saved whole nations--not even Israel, though one day, at Christ's return, "all Israel shall be saved" (Rom. 11:26). But we may be certain that

[136] *Christianity Today,* Jan. 21, 1966.

in this present dispensation God will not save any nation. At Babel He scattered the Gentiles and shortly after the close of Acts He scattered Israel. Now what we have left is a world of individuals needing Christ. Rom. 11:32 says:

"God hath concluded them all in unbelief, that He might have mercy upon all."

One thing is evident: No evangelist or evangelistic association has been eminently successful in bringing America or any other nation to God.

Billy Graham agrees that "There is no possibility that the nations of the world can solve the problems of human nature until He [Christ] comes again,"[137] but he seems to think, like Fife and Glasser, that Christ's return can be brought about by the preaching of the gospel. He certainly has the salvation of the world in view when he says, as he often does:

"Christ can save the world only as He is living in the hearts of men and women."[138]

But Christ will not save the world by "living in the hearts of men and women." He will save it--in one sense--by His personal return to earth (See Jer. 23:5).

The confusing results of trying to labor under the so-called "great commission" are again seen in Ockenga's remarks about miraculous signs:

"There is no biblical evidence," says Ockenga "requiring us to believe that God has withdrawn these gifts. If the curtain came down on the supernatural manifestations of the Holy Spirit with the close of the apostolic era, there is nothing in Scripture to indicate this.. . Intelligent and responsible individuals have testified to receiving the gifts... God may be giving a supernatural demonstration that will confound unbelief."[139]

This, though as far as we know Dr. Ockenga does not speak in tongues, cast out demons or raise the dead. But the point is that if the "great commission" is God's program for today the genuineness (not the degree) of any man's faith may be brought into question who is not able to work at least some of these miracles. "He that believeth and is baptized shall be saved.. *. and these signs shall follow them that believe."* This is the exact wording of Mark 16:16,17, and Peter, working under this commission, said:

"Repent, and be baptized every one of you in the name of Jesus Christ for the remission of sins, AND YE SHALL RECEIVE THE GIFT OF THE HOLY GHOST" (Acts 2:38).

If, then, the "great commission" is God's program for today, Dr. Ockenga's personal salvation, as well as that of this writer may be called in question.

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[137] *World Aflame,* P. 229.
[138] *Ibid*., P. 187.
[139] "The Basic Theology of Evangelism," *Christianity Today,* Oct. 28, 1968.

Dr. Ockenga does not seem very sure of his position here, however, for he says:

"The claim is made today that these gifts are reappearing in the charismatic movement... Should this movement prove valid and a modern manifestation of the supernatural, it could be the answer to the rationalists in the Church."[140]

How we wish that Dr. 0ckenga, Dr. Henry and all our neo-evangelical friends could see the relevance of what Paul, by divine inspiration, calls, *"My gospel, and the preaching of Jesus Christ according to the revelation of the mystery"* (Rom. 16:25). How this would answer their questions about the sign gifts, clear up their confusion as to God's program for today and give us all a solid basis for united effort in evangelizing our generation with *"the gospel of the grace of God."*

Much has been said by Dr. Henry and other neo-evangelicals about "evangelism in depth." Actually their evangelism has been shallow indeed. Naturally, for while pledging themselves to carry out the so-called "great commission" they have not even stopped to consider that this commission says nothing whatever about the remission of sins (for Gentiles as well as Jews) through Christ's blood, or about salvation by grace through faith alone, or about Jews and Gentiles being reconciled to God in one Body, or about our divine baptism into Christ and His Body, or about a heavenly position, heavenly blessings and a heavenly prospect. For all this we must go to the epistles of Paul.

SPIRITUAL WEAKNESS

It was in 1947 that Dr. Harold John Ockenga gave the New Evangelicalism its name and proclaimed a manifesto as to its aims and intentions. Neo-evangelicalism was in fact already in existence, but Dr. Ockenga launched the movement in an official way.

Ten years later Dr. Ockenga said in retrospect:

"Fundamentalism abdicated leadership and responsibility in the societal realm and thus became impotent to change society or to solve social problems."

Before we quote further, we should remind our readers that it is now more than twenty years since the neo-evangelicals "took over." Have *they,* in all these twenty years, succeeded in changing society? Have *they* solved our social problems? Anyone with eyes half open must see that the condition of society at large is far worse than it was twenty years ago. But Ockenga continued:

"The New Evangelicalism has changed its strategy from one of separation[141] to one of infiltration... The results have been phenomenal... Since I first coined the

[140] *Ibid*.
[141] In direct violation of Scripture, which says: "Come out from among them [unbelievers,] and *be ye separate."*

phrase, 'The New Evangelicalism,' at a convocation address at *Fuller Theological Seminary* ten years ago, the evangelical forces have been welded into an organizational front. First, there is the *National Association of Evangelicals,* which pro-vides articulation for the movement on the denominational level; second, there is *World Evangelical Fellowship,* which binds together these individual national associations of some twenty-six countries into a world organization; third, there is the new apologetic literature, stating this point of view which is now flowing from the presses of the great publishers... fourth, there is the existence of *Fuller Theological Seminary* and other evangelical seminaries which are fully committed to orthodox Christianity and a resultant social philosophy; fifth, there is the establishment of *Christianity Today,* a bi-weekly publication, to articulate the convictions of this movement; sixth, there is the appearance of an evangelist, Billy Graham, who on a mass level is the spokesman of the convictions and ideals of the New Evangelicalism."[142]

We have now had ten more years of the New Evangelicalism to observe *its* success in changing society and solving social problems. Ten more years to consider the claim that "the results have been phenomenal."

Phenomenal? *Disastrous* would be a better word.

Society has changed in these last twenty years to be sure--for the worst. Our social problems are now so grave that this great nation is threatened with anarchy. The races battle each other in the streets; labor takes the law into its own hands to intimidate industry; morals, as we have seen, are at an all-time low while crime and lawlessness are at an all-time high. Meanwhile our judicial system hinders the police from enforcing the law. So serious is the situation that law-abiding citizens are afraid to leave their homes at night.

Should we not now ask: If fundamentalism abdicated leadership, impotent to change society or to solve social problems, is it not high time that neo-evangelicalism abdicates before the situation becomes even more acute?

At least, should not the leaders of neo-evangelicalism give up their unscriptural philosophies and turn to a ministry of obedience to God, that separates itself from the world and apostate religion, that places greater emphasis on the need for prayer, Bible study and Spirit-empowered service than on organizing, advertising and compromising to reach the lost? Should they not give up their dream about "leadership in the societal realm" and realize that God gave this world up to judgment nineteen hundred years ago, but has given us a message of grace to proclaim to the lost until the time is ripe for Him to recall his ambassadors and visit the world with judgment? (See Rom. 11:32; II Thes. 2:7-12.) Should they not give themselves to *expository teaching* of the Word, *rightly divided,* recognizing the great Pauline commission as our Lord's commission to us? (See II Cor. 5:14-21; Eph. 3:1-11.) If they did this today a refreshing spiritual revival would sweep

[142] From a news release of Dr. Ockenga, Dec. 8, 1957, as quoted by Wm. E. Ashbrook in *The New Neutralism,* Pp. 4. 5. This testimony is too important to be ignored by those who question that Billy Graham is a neo-evangelical.

through the Body of Christ tomorrow and souls would be saved *and established* in unprecedented numbers.

The fact is that the Church's mission in the world is *not to* change society or to solve its social problems. But it is also a fact that a strong, separated Church, true to its calling, *teaching the* Bible and proclaiming Christ to a lost world, has always had a profound effect upon society.

This leads us to point out the basic spiritual weakness of the New Evangelicalism.

DOING THINGS BIG

Where evangelism is concerned, the neo-evangelicals have apparently given themselves over to the philosophy of "doing things big." Money is no object. Millions of dollars are spent to advertise widely and "do the thing up brown." This is just what makes so many people think that the new evangelicalism really is phenomenally successful.

The new evangelicalism, in the past twenty years, has been largely characterized by high-powered, streamlined organization, dazzling lights, spotlights on converted movie stars, beauty queens, sports figures, popular singers (many of them still half in the world); the delayed entrance, the conversion-thriller, the power-packed drama. All this is now familiar to evangelism, while the need for a separated life, a ministry bathed in prayer, the leading and power of the Holy Spirit, the true desire to see all the glory go to God--all this is little emphasized and still less practiced.

The leaders of neo-evangelicalism are found hobnobbing with prominent worldly figures--to lead them to Christ, of course. And this has had its effect upon the world. Christians are so worldly that many worldlings find it quite attractive to be religious. Christian leaders look at the leaders of worldliness and say: "If only we could win that noted actor or actress, think what crowds we could draw and what a testimony it would be." And some worldlings respond: "These Christians are maturing. They are more tolerant than they used to be. I think I'll join them." And so the new evangelicalism leads the Church down the road to tolerance of--and indulgence in--worldliness and sin.

How foreign all this is to what we read in the Epistles of Paul, the greatest evangelist of all time. He wrote by divine inspiration; therefore his words are nothing less than God's Word to us. With this in mind consider his words to the Corinthian believers:

"And I was with you in weakness, and in fear, and in much trembling.

"And my speech and my preaching was not with enticing [persuasive] words of man's wisdom, but in demonstration of the Spirit and of power:

"That your faith should not stand in the wisdom of men, but in the power of God" (I Cor. 2:3-5).

In II Cor. 4:4 he calls the gospel "the good news of the glory of *Christ,"* and goes on to say:

"For we preach not ourselves, but Christ Jesus the Lord; and ourselves your servants for Jesus' sake" (Ver. 5).

"But we have this treasure in earthen vessels, that the excellency of the power may be of God, and not of us" (Ver. 7).

And to the Galatians he writes:

"But God forbid that I should glory, save in the cross of our Lord Jesus Christ, by whom the world is crucified unto me and I unto the world" (Gal. 6:14).

The current emphasis on methods rather than the message, on man rather than on God, is a natural by-product of Arminianism. We have just finished reading *Missions in Crisis* by Fife and Glasser How well it portrays the problems, the opportunities and the challenge that face the Church today! How many good methods it suggests to reach the lost for Christ! But that is all: the problems, the opportunities, the challenge, the methods. One would have hoped that in a volume on *missions in crisis* he would have found much about the need for true separation to God, for more earnest prayer, for a clearer grasp of God's message for our times, for a strong, Spirit-empowered testimony, but all this is conspicuous by its absence. Man and his methods have been placed above God and His claims.

The late Dr. A. W. Tozer dealt well with this problem when he wrote:

"The flaw in current evangelism lies in its humanistic approach... It is frankly fascinated by the great, noisy, aggressive world with its big name, its hero worship, its wealth and its garish pageantry... In this quasi-Christian scheme of things God becomes the Aladdin lamp who does the bidding of everyone that will accept His Son and sign a card . . . This gross misapprehension of the truth is back of much (I almost said most) of our present evangelical activity. It determines directions, builds programs, decides the content of sermons, fixes the quality of local churches and even of whole denominations, sets the pattern for religious writers and forms the editorial policy of many evangelical publications . . . At bottom it is little more than weak humanism allied with weak Christianity to give it ecclesiastical respectability. It may be identified by its religious approach. Invariably it begins with man and his needs, and then looks around for God. True Christianity reveals God as searching for man to deliver him from his ambitions."[143]

From the facts we have presented above it is evident that the New Evangelicalism, rather than proving a "phenomenal success" has, by Biblical standards, turned out to be a disaster from which the Church of Christ may take

[143] From "Born After Midnight," as quoted by DeVern F. Fromke in *The Ultimate Intention,* P. 187.

many years to recover--*if* God, in grace, gives it those years. At any rate it is now high time for sincere Bible believers to recognize this movement for what it is and repudiate it, turning back to the path of Scriptural, loving separation to our Lord, *"that in all things He might have the preeminence."* Those who do this sincerely and without reservation will surely be led by the divine Author of the Scriptures to see that *our* great commission is found, not in the words of the earthly Jesus to His circumcision apostles, but in the glorious revelation which He later committed to Paul, the chief of sinners saved by grace. When they see this the gospel they preach will no longer be confused and ambiguous but pointed and powerful. And the division which has gripped the Church because of its inability to agree as to legalism, water baptism, the work of the Holy Spirit, the coming of Christ, etc., will vanish.

May God grant that His blood-bought people may still open their hearts to "the preaching of Jesus Christ according to the revelation of the mystery," and enjoy the oneness that we so sorely need to effectively evangelize the lost.

Chapter X

A RESOLUTION

On Friday, September 9th, 1966, the Board of Directors of *Berean Bible Society* voted unanimously to publish the following resolution regarding the new evangelicalism, with signatures of the individual members attached. The next day the members of the office staff enthusiastically added their signatures as an expression of their stand. We thank God for the united front which *Berean Bible Society* thus presents in this important matter.

A RESOLUTION

REGARDING THE NEW EVANGELICALISM

WHEREAS a "new evangelicalism" has arisen in America, the proponents of which do not wish to be known as fundamentalists, but rather as evangelicals, and

WHEREAS leading proponents of the same neo-evangelicalism, while claiming to believe firmly in the fundamentals of the Christian faith, nevertheless assume compromising positions and make compromising statements regarding the fundamentals, and

WHEREAS the said neo-evangelicals, hoping to win greater numbers to Christ and to win liberals to conservative theology, disobey the clear commands of God as to separation from the world (John 15:19; Rom. 12:2; II Cor. 6:14-17; Jas. 4:4; I John 2:15; 5:19), and especially from apostates from the faith (Tit. 3:10; II John 10,11), and

WHEREAS the said neo-evangelicals in their "concern for society," use passages of Scripture which refer to other dispensations (e.g., II Chron. 7:14) and apply them to society today, thus perverting God's revealed program for the present dispensation, and

WHEREAS neo-evangelicals, with few exceptions, reject and oppose dispensational truth in general and the truth of "the mystery" revealed to Paul in particular, and

WHEREAS neo-evangelicalism is being promoted by some of the largest religious periodicals and institutions of learning, and has made serious inroads among fundamentalists and has even gained a foothold in the so-called "Grace movement," now therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED, that the *Berean Bible Society* go on record as standing without compromise or reservation for,

1. All the fundamentals of the Christian faith, including in particular the inerrancy and infallibility of the Holy Scriptures, in their original writings, as opposed to the view of some neo-evangelicals that they are merely an "adequate" revelation.

2. Obedience to the clear commands of Scripture as to the believer's separation from the world and from apostate unbelievers, as opposed to neo-evangelicalism's unequal yoke with both. We particularly oppose the unscriptural, unethical and dishonest doctrine of "infiltration" into liberal churches by evangelicals with a view to regaining control of the apostate denominations.

3. Obedience to God's command to inform men that "the world," i.e., this world system, is doomed to destruction and that "the gospel of the grace of God" is *a message of personal, individual salvation* from "this present evil age" (Gal. 1:4) as well as from the judgment to come, as opposed to neo-evangelicalism's appeal to nations and to society in an effort to improve world conditions.

4. Our responsibility to "rightly divide the Word of truth," proclaiming the unadulterated "gospel of the grace of God" and the "preaching of Jesus Christ *according to the revelation of the mystery," as* opposed to neo-evangelicalism's confusion of "the gospel of the grace of God" with "the gospel of the kingdom," the Body of Christ with the Kingdom of Christ and the mission of the twelve apostles with that of the Apostle Paul.

Finally, BE IT RESOLVED that we continue to designate ourselves as Bible-believing *"fundamentalists,"* this designation indicating that we stand for the fundamentals of the faith, as compared with the terms "conservative" and "evangelical," which convey little definite meaning and may indeed be used to convey false impressions.

The above resolution signed by all members of the board of directors and the office staff of *Berean Bible Society.*